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ECOSYSTEM BALANCE

The silent guardians of nature

Protecting the endangered Asiatic elephant indirectly helps safeguard India's forests as powerful carbon stores, finds new scientific study

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INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY

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Fake patents poisoning India's race for academic excellence

SCIENCE » PAGE 16

What does the FCRA amendment mean for NGOs?

FAQ » PAGE 17

India meets Australia, needs a win to make it to the semifinal

SPORT » PAGE 20

NEARBY

Manickam Tagore appointed new TNCC president

CHENNAI
Three-time Lok Sabha MP B. Manickam Tagore has been appointed as president of the Tamil Nadu Congress Committee. » PAGE 6

Scattered showers likely in T.N. till June end

CHENNAI
Scattered rainfall is likely to continue across the State till the end of June, while near-normal temperatures are expected to prevail. » PAGE 6

CLASSIFIEDS » PAGES 8, 9 & 10
MAGAZINE » 8 PAGES
DOWNTOWN » 8PAGES
(TABLOID) (IN SELECT AREAS)

Ram Temple row: Trust general secretary quits

Trust promises fair investigation into the donation embezzlement case as its general secretary and another member submit resignation; it assures devotees that offerings made by them are safe

Mayank Kumar
LUCKNOW

Amid the uproar over the Ram Temple donation embezzlement case, the Shri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust on Saturday announced that its general secretary Champat Rai and member Anil Mishra had submitted their resignations. “At its next meeting, the trust will take a decision on their resignations,” Trust treasurer Govind Dev Giri said in a statement on Saturday. The statement comes a day after the Vishwa Hindu Parishad (VHP) denied reports of Mr. Rai’s resignation. Mr. Rai is also the vice-president of the VHP. In its first public statement amid the controver-



The Ram temple Trust general secretary, Champat Rai, and other members are facing criticism over an embezzlement case. FILE PHOTO

sy, the Trust, which administers the Ram Temple in Ayodhya, said it would ensure a fair investigation into the incident. “We are deeply pained, shocked, and extremely saddened by the incidents that have come to light in recent days at the Ram Temple in Ayodhya. As agents of all Ram devotees and Ram sevaks serving the Lord, we are committed to ensuring a fair investigation and restoring the confidence of devotees,” the statement added. Mr. Rai and other Trust members are facing criticism over the donation theft case in which eight

people have been arrested on charges of embezzlement, criminal conspiracy, fraud and breach of trust. In the statement, the Trust said silver bricks, jewellery, and other offerings that the devotees had personally handed over to its officials are “safe and fully accounted for”. “As regards the alleged embezzlement of money from the temple’s donation boxes, an FIR has been filed, based on the interim report submitted by the Special Investigation Team. Legal proceedings are under way, truth will come out and the guilty will be punished,” reads the statement.

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DISSOLUTION DEMAND
» PAGE 13

Iran says U.S. violated peace deal as both sides trade fire

Agence France-Presse
TEHRAN

Iran on Saturday accused the U.S. of violating their deal to end the war, after Washington launched strikes on Iranian territory and Tehran responded with attacks on U.S. targets in the Gulf.

The trading of fire, which came after Washington accused Tehran of attacking a cargo ship in the Strait of Hormuz, raised doubts about efforts to keep the crucial waterway open while both sides negotiate a final deal.

U.S. Central Command (CENTCOM) said the latest American strikes, which targeted Iranian missile and drone storage sites and coastal radar positions, were a response to “unwarranted aggression against commercial shipping by Iranian forces” that “clearly violated the ceasefire”. It described the latest strikes as “a powerful response” to the “attack on a



Vessels seen in the Strait of Hormuz near Bandar Abbas in Iran following the signing of the deal with U.S. to end the war. REUTERS

commercial ship that was transiting the Strait of Hormuz”. “Violence will be met with violence” if Iran carries out any further attacks, U.S. Vice-President J.D. Vance said. Iran said “these brutal attacks... are a blatant violation” of the deal to end the war, which began with U.S.-Israeli strikes on Iran in late February. Its Revolutionary Guards said they had struck U.S. sites in the Gulf region and that “if the aggression is repeated, our response will be broader”. Bahrain said it was tar-

geted by several Iranian drones early on Saturday and accused Tehran of “sabotaging peace efforts”. On the U.S. strikes, Iranian media reported an explosion at a pier in the southern city of Sirik late on Friday. It quoted a military source saying a “projectile impact” caused the blast. “Sirik Port is operating normally,” Mehr news agency later said.

A SHIPWRECKED HEGEMON
» PAGE 18
‘GRAVE BLUNDER’
» PAGE 19

Maharashtra TET put off over ‘paper leak’

The Hindu Bureau
MUMBAI

The Maharashtra government on Saturday postponed the Teacher Eligibility Test (TET) 2026 over allegations of a “paper leak”. Around six lakh candidates were expected to appear for the examination on Sunday. “This decision was taken to make the examination transparent,” the government stated in a press release. The new date for the examination will be announced later. Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis has ordered a probe. The Opposition

slammed the government over the alleged leak. “Why is the government not capable of holding a single exam transparently? If it does not act strictly, we will hit the streets,” State Congress president Harshwardhan Sapkal said. The decision to postpone the exam was taken after an investigation by the Bhiwandi police in Thane found people in possession of questions similar to those in the TET paper.

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» PAGE 12
‘THEFT OF FUTURE’
» PAGE 14

Safer playground



Friendly fight: Greater one-horned rhinoceros calves play on higher ground at the Pobitora Wildlife Sanctuary in Morigaon, Assam, on Saturday as low-lying regions remain inundated after heavy rainfall in the State and neighbouring Arunachal Pradesh. PTI

MDMK cuts ties with DMK, backs TVK govt.

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Marumalarchi Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (MDMK) has officially severed ties with the DMK-led Secular Progressive Alliance. A formal resolution to withdraw from the coalition was passed unanimously during the party’s 32nd General Council meeting here on Saturday. Following the meeting, MDMK general secretary Vaiko announced that the party would extend its support to the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK) government and will abstain from contesting the upcoming

byelections to back the ruling party. 23 resolutions passed The general council passed a total of 23 resolutions, with the primary resolution focusing on the exit from the DMK alliance. According to the first resolution, the decision to sever ties was prompted by post-election developments, where arrangements were allegedly made to install the AIADMK – which won only 47 seats in alliance with the BJP – in power. CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 6

Two BJP-ruled States question VB-G RAM G financial burden

Sobhana K. Nair
NEW DELHI

At least three States, two of them with BJP-led governments, have raised concerns over the increased financial burden on them under the new rural employment programme, the Viksit Bharat-Guarantee for Rozgar and Aajeevika Mission (Gramin) (VB-G RAM G), which comes into effect on July 1. Under the scheme, a majority of the States have to bear 40% of the total expenditure, in contrast to its predecessor legislation,

Budget concern

States are required to bear 40% of the total expenditure under the VB-G RAM G scheme

	Current share*	For 125 days of work
Bihar	₹4,477 cr.	₹15,939 cr.
M.P.	₹4,168 cr.	₹20,037 cr.
Jharkhand	₹1,804 cr.	₹9,293 cr.

The new scheme is set to come into effect on July 1

*As per interim fund allocation

the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MGNREGA). Under MGNREGA, the Centre bore 100% of the

wage bill and the States had to pay only a part of the material bill, which accounted for only 10% of the total budget. As per a Right to Information reply, Bihar, Madhya Pradesh – both ruled by the BJP – and Jharkhand have explicitly asked for a reconsideration of the funding pattern with analysis showing that the 40% share of interim allocation under the scheme will be inadequate to keep the promise of 125 work days. STATES SEEK REVIEW
» PAGE 13

Screenplay maestro, everyday hero takes his last bow

B. Kolappan
CHENNAI

Renowned Tamil actor, director, writer, and screenwriter K. Bhagyaraj, whose mastery over screenplay was widely acknowledged and who created a storytelling formula that has influenced generations of filmmakers, died on Saturday. He was 73. Sources said he suffered a massive heart attack. Speaking at his residence, actor Suhasin Maniratnam said Bhagyaraj had returned to Chennai on Friday night after attending actor Khushboo’s daughter’s wedding in Goa. On Saturday morning,

he went for a walk with his wife Poornima, but complained of chest pain on his return home. He was rushed to Apollo Hospital and efforts were made to resuscitate him, but they proved futile. Bhagyaraj directed, produced and starred in numerous hit films celebrated for their engaging storylines, memorable songs, and relatable characters. Mounageethangal, Antha Ezhu Naatkal, and Munthanai Mudichu are some of his films being studied even today. Nearly every film of Bhagyaraj spoke loudly about an idea which found an echo within Tamil society.



An assistant of Bharathiraja who also died recently, Bhagyaraj forever changed the perception of the Tamil film hero by proving that wit, intelligence, and ordinariness could be as com-

deeply human. His idea of a hero was not even the man next door, but one among the many on the streets. He also tried his hand at politics, being an ardent fan of M.G. Ramachandran, though he was not very successful in this sphere. He edited the Tamil weekly magazine Bhagyaa and authored several novels as well. His funeral will be held on Sunday afternoon at the Besant Nagar Crematorium with State honours. CONTINUED ON
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MORE REPORTS ON
» PAGES 2 & 6

Police open fire at murder suspect attempting to flee after youth dies in assault

Accused shot in knee during arrest; he and seven others were held after entering a house and attacking its occupants, resulting in death of the youth and injuries to his father and brother

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Chennai police apprehended a murder suspect Rupesh, 23, after opening fire at him, and arrested seven others who allegedly trespassed into a house and attacked its occupants, resulting in the death of a youth.

Two others, including the deceased youth's father and brother, were stabbed.

The police said a 48-year-old woman, Selvi, residing on Union Road, Chinna Nolambur in Chennai, lodged a complaint stating that on Friday night, her sons, Sharath, 27, and Sanjay, 24, were filling water from a tanker lorry near their house when they got into an argument with Udhayaraj, 21, a resident of the same locality.



Rupesh

During the altercation, Sharath and Sanjay allegedly assaulted Udhaya before returning home.

A short while later, Udhaya allegedly returned with his brothers, Rakesh Raja, 26, and Karthik Raja, 28, and several friends.

The group allegedly trespassed into the family's house and attacked Sharath and Sanjay with knives.

When their father, Mu-

rugadas, attempted to intervene, he was also stabbed before the assailants fled the scene. All three injured were rushed to the Kilpauk Medical College Hospital.

However, Sanjay died on the way, while Sharath and Murugadas are undergoing treatment.

Case registered

Based on Selvi's complaint, the Nolambur police registered a case under sections relating to murder and attempt to murder and launched an investigation.

Following instructions from the Greater Chennai Police Commissioner, A. Amalraj, three special teams headed by the Inspector of Nolambur police station were formed to trace and arrest the accused.

During the operation, the police attempted to ap-

prehend the prime accused, Rupesh, of Perumal Koil Street, Maduravoyal. The police said Rupesh allegedly attacked the officers and tried to escape. Acting in self-defence, the police said they shot him in the knee before taking him into custody.

Probe on

The police also arrested seven other accused: Naveenkumar, 24, of Bethel Nagar, Injambakkam; Udhaya, of Perumal Koil Street, Maduravoyal; Surya, 20, of MMDA Colony, Maduravoyal; Karthik, of Perumal Koil Street; Rakesh, of Perumal Koil Street, Maduravoyal; Meshak, 22, of Perumal Koil Street, Maduravoyal; and Suryaprakash, 27, of Perumal Koil Street, Maduravoyal.

Further investigation is under way, the police said.

Outgoing DGP urges T.N. Police to be a citizen-centric force

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A farewell parade was conducted on Saturday in honour of senior IPS officer and Director-General of Police/Director of Tamil Nadu Fire and Rescue Services Seema Agrawal. The 1993-batch IPS officer is retiring from service on attaining the age of superannuation at the end of this month.

Director-General of Police and Head of Police Force Mahesh Kumar Agarwal and other senior police officers greeted her on the occasion and the personnel of Armed Reserve conducted the parade at Rajarathinam Stadium.

Reflections on career

In a farewell address, the outgoing DGP urged Tamil Nadu Police personnel to build a more humane, compassionate, and citizen-centric police force, while reflecting on her 36 years of service.

Recalling her career across law and order, investigation, and various specialised units, the se-



Outgoing DGP Seema Agrawal felicitated by DGP/HoPF Mahesh Kumar Agarwal in the city on Saturday.

nior officer said her assignments in special wings gave her a unique perspective on policing. "Sometimes, the view from the sidelines is far more vivid, like the sky at sunrise and sunset," she remarked, adding that years of mindful observation had prompted her to reflect on the future direction of policing.

Describing the Tamil Nadu Police as one of the country's finest forces with a rich legacy, Ms. Agrawal said continuous self-assessment would help the organisation reach greater heights.



THE HINDU

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CHENNAI

SUNDAY, JUN. 28		
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RISE	17:29	SET 04:04
MONDAY, JUN. 29		
RISE	05:46	SET 18:39
RISE	18:19	SET 04:54
TUESDAY, JUN. 30		
RISE	05:47	SET 18:39
RISE	19:09	SET 05:47

Chennai Weather	max	min
Tiruvallur	40	26
Chennai Airport	39	28
Chennai City	38	28

Chennai Airport Today
36°C The weather will be very warm and uneasy. Night will also be uneasy. Spell of light rain and thundershowers may occur.

Chennai Airport Tomorrow
37°C Morning will be comfortable. Day will be very warm and uneasy. Chances of light rain and thundershowers. Night will also be uneasy.

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Experts stress need for measures to tackle global health emergencies

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Emphasising the need for preparedness measures ahead of the next pandemic or global health emergency, experts at *The Hindu's* webinar, 'Ebola: Preparing for the Next Pandemic', said there was an urgent need for better lab and testing infrastructure, for training and resources for healthcare workers, data to be shared across stakeholders and for trust to be built within communities to combat misinformation.

Ebola outbreak

Parthesarathy Rajendran, executive director, Médecins Sans Frontières South Asia, dwelt on the Ebola

outbreak in the Democratic Republic of Congo and neighbouring Uganda, explaining how cases shot up, why contact tracing remained a cornerstone of controlling infection spread, the need to work with communities to build education and awareness around infection protocols and prevention measures, and to ensure dignified burials for all patients.

Hamsadvani Kuganantham, consultant, WHO South-East Asia Regional Office; global health research manager, The Global Health Network, University of Oxford, stressed the need for countries, including India, to be part of preparedness protocols, to strengthen disease surveillance across the country,

for data to be shared to allow for research to be carried out and the importance of incorporating the One Health Approach with public health measures.

Vijayalakshmi Balakrishnan, senior consultant in infectious diseases at Kauvery Hospitals, Chennai, explained how zoonotic infections were handled, clinically: from diagnosis to management, treatment and patient education.

She also highlighted the need for data analytics from the State government that could help clinicians anticipate an outbreak.

The webinar was part of *The Hindu's* Health Webinar Series.

It can be viewed at: <https://newsth.live/Ebola-prep>

Govt. cancels tender for Detailed Feasibility Report after backlash

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Tamil Nadu government has cancelled a tender to appoint consultants for preparing a Detailed Feasibility Report (DFR) on overhauling solid waste management contracts in 12 municipal corporations, after backlash.

The solid waste management in these urban local bodies had already been privatised in 2022. However, the recently floated ₹4.05-crore tender for preparing the DFR was mis-

The tender was intended to develop a framework for fresh sanitation contracts

construed by many as a fresh attempt to privatise waste management operations, a source in the Corporation told *The Hindu*.

To clear the confusion, the State has decided to review the existing system, identify gaps, bring further improvements, and take a decision in due course, the

official said. The tender, floated earlier this month through the Tamil Nadu Urban Infrastructure Financial Services Limited (TNUIFSL), was intended to develop a framework for fresh sanitation contracts as the existing three-year outsourced conservancy agreements neared completion in the municipal corporations of Tambaram, Avadi, Kancheepuram, Tiruvannamalai, Vellore, Salem, Erode, Tiruppur, Tiruchi, Madurai, Tirunelveli, and Thoothukudi.

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Caution thrown to the wind: A government committee has recommended the permanent closure of the company where an ammonia gas leak has claimed 16 lives so far. B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

The ammonia gas leak at a seafood processing unit in Tiruvallur district, near Chennai, has emerged as one of TN's deadliest industrial disasters in recent years. **R. Sivaraman** traces what exactly happened, through eyewitness accounts, survivor testimonies, and medical evidence. The incident also raises serious questions about industrial safety, emergency preparedness, and the conditions of migrants employed far away from home

Painful memory: Doctors said many workers arrived at hospitals in a state of panic, suffering from giddiness, difficulty in breathing and lip oedema, or swelling. Some patients required immediate intubation. B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

Doctors reported that many workers arrived in a state of panic, suffering from giddiness, difficulty in breathing and lip oedema, or swelling. Examination of the throat revealed laryngeal oedema caused by ammonia inhalation. Some patients required immediate intubation, while steroids were administered to reduce inflammation. E. Tharanirajan, Additional Director of Medical Education, noted that there is no specific antidote for ammonia inhalation, making a supportive line of management essential. "Exposure affected the eyes, nose and respiratory tract. When lungs are involved, it can cause acute respiratory distress syndrome (ARDS), while tissue hypoxia can compromise the heart, causing myo-

A three-member expert committee constituted by the Tamil Nadu government has recommended the permanent closure of the company. Sources said the committee has also recommended that 1,774 factories across the State that use hazardous chemicals be inspected. It has noted that around 60 seafood export companies, similar to the one in Tiruvallur, are operating across the State, and a decision has been taken to conduct continuous inspections at these units.

INBRIEF



AEC Chairman reviews progress at Kalpakkam

A.K. Mohanty, Chairman of the Atomic Energy Commission (AEC) and Secretary of the Department of Atomic Energy, visited the 500 MW Prototype Fast Breeder Reactor at Kalpakkam on Saturday to review critical technical milestones. He assessed the plant's current status along with P.A. Suresh Babu, Chief Managing Director of Bharatiya Nabhikiya Vidyut Nigam Limited, and other senior officials. The review focused on ongoing low-power physics experiments and the overhauling of the Turbine Generator (TG) system. The TG overhauling is being executed by its Original Equipment Manufacturer, Bharat Heavy Electricals Limited (BHEL). During the visit, the Chairman also interacted with the BHEL engineering team.

GCC removes unauthorised hoardings in Teynampet

The Greater Chennai Corporation (GCC) removed 54 unauthorised advertisement hoardings and collected ₹2.29 lakh in penalties during a special enforcement drive in Teynampet zone on Saturday. According to a press release, action was taken against hoardings erected without the mandatory licence. The civic body said licences for advertisement hoardings are issued only after scrutiny by a single-window committee and compliance with prescribed norms. It added that drives to remove unauthorised hoardings and penalise violators would continue across the city.

Rotary Club donates neonatal ambulance to city hospital

The Rotary Club of Madras East, in partnership with the Rotary Club of Irvine and Rotary district 5320, Irvine, USA, donated a neonatal ambulance worth ₹72 lakh to Kanchi Kamakoti CHILDS Trust Hospital in Chennai under Project SHISHU. According to a release, it is equipped with a transport incubator, neonatal ventilator, and advanced life-support systems. The ambulance will ensure critical care for extremely premature neonates born as early as 24 weeks and weighing under 600 grams. The ambulance was handed over by chief guest Muruganandam M., RI Vice President 2026-2027, RI Director 2025-27 in the presence of Guest of Honour Vinod Saraogi to Medical Director of Kanchi Kamakoti CHILDS Trust Hospital Janani Sankar.

Metro commuters struggle to get paper QR tickets; staff issue handwritten slips

Owing to network and UPS issues, CMRL staff have been unable to generate paper tickets with QR code on some occasions over the past 15 days; airport station sees long queue as ticketing services get affected; commuters complain on social media; official says CMRL will address the problem

TRACK TALES

Sunitha Sekar
CHENNAI

Ticketing services of Chennai Metro Rail Limited (CMRL) faced glitches on Friday morning. Metro staff issued handwritten slips to commuters as they were unable to generate tickets with QR code.

Later that night, the on-line ticketing services failed to work again for a while, causing inconvenience to commuters.

This was not the first such incident. In the past

15 days, there have been instances where paper QR tickets could not be issued owing to network issues. According to CMRL officials, on Friday morning, the issue was with the UPS.

Official's assurance

"We have already identified the problem. We will ensure this does not happen again," a Metro official said.

While CMRL has a significant number of regular commuters who use the National Common Mobility Cards for their travel, nearly 20% of the CMRL travellers still opt to buy paper QR tickets from the coun-



Ticket trouble: Nearly 20% of the CMRL commuters buy paper tickets from the counters at the stations. REPRESENTATIVE IMAGE

ters at the stations.

Sources said that issuing paper QR tickets had been difficult for the staff in the past two weeks.

"There were network

outages during peak hours, as a result of which we had to hand out handwritten slips that passed off as tickets. Though it occurred for a brief period,

since it was rush hour, it caused the commuters much inconvenience. The downside of such manual tickets is we could lose the actual count of passengers and there may be potential revenue leakage as well," a source said.

Long wait

Vinoba Bhoopathy, a frequent commuter, said that because of the network issue, the Chennai International Airport station was packed on Friday night. "There was a long queue. The staff said they were issuing manual tickets. Several air passengers and regular commuters suffered

due to this issue. I waited for nearly 20 minutes, and only after the network issue was rectified did I get the QR ticket. In the past too, I have had problems getting the WhatsApp ticket," he added.

Commuters flagged this problem on social media, too. One of the commuters, Gunasekar, posted: "Chennai Metro QR & site Downtime. None of the app nor Ticket counter functions. Only NCMC cards & Physical literally Handwritten tickets are being issued @cmrlofficial @CumtaOfficial please resolve soon and make announcements!"

Activists' body urges NCPCR to take action against Minister for touching athletes' legs

Meghna M.
CHENNAI

The Tamil Nadu Child Rights Watch (TNCRW) has urged the National Commission for Protection of Child Rights (NCPCR) to take action against Higher Education Minister P. Viswanathan for touching the legs of girl athletes at a school programme in Madurai.

In a letter to the commission, the child rights body requested that it take suo motu cognisance of the incident, and called for a report from the State government.

At an event held recently at the Government School in Melur, the Minister had approached a group of girl athletes, touched their outstretched legs and cracked their toes while conversing with them.

Stating that the matter concerns the fundamental

obligation of the State and all public authorities to protect children, TNCRW convener Jesu Rathinam said, "Every allegation involving the physical boundaries of children deserve prompt, transparent, and independent scrutiny so that public confidence in child protection mechanisms is maintained."

Appropriate protocols

It also urged the NCPCR to recommend appropriate protocols for all government departments, educational institutions, and organisers of public events involving children to ensure that interactions by public officials strictly respect children's bodily autonomy, consent, dignity, and child protection norms.

TNCRW co-convenor A. Devaneyan said the commission should also direct the Tamil Nadu Director-General of Police to ensure

that the matter is examined, and if facts disclose a cognisable offence, an FIR should be registered and an impartial investigation conducted in accordance with the provisions of the POCSO Act and other applicable laws.

School events

Additionally, the child rights body has written to Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay regarding the programmes organised at a few government schools to celebrate Mr. Vijay's birthday.

"The events held in schools were neither educationally appropriate nor consistent with the purpose of schools," co-convenor Stegana Jency said.

The TNCRW urged the Chief Minister to direct the School Education Department to inquire into the incidents and take appropriate action in cases where educational institu-

tions were been used for activities inconsistent with established educational norms.

"Initiate appropriate disciplinary action against any individuals, including political functionaries or school authorities, who may have encouraged such activities that compromise the neutrality of educational institutions," the letter added.

It also urged the department to issue comprehensive guidelines prohibiting the use of schools for political publicity, personality-centred celebrations, partisan campaigns, or any such activities.

"The department must also establish a mechanism for reporting and addressing instances where external individuals or organisations attempt to use educational institutions for purposes unrelated to children's education," Mr. Devaneyan added.

Man from Bengaluru arrested for murder of pregnant woman

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Sankar Nagar police have arrested a 30-year-old man from Bengaluru for allegedly stabbing to death a 29-year-old woman, with whom he was in a relationship, after she refused to accompany him to Bengaluru and live with him.

The investigation began after the police recovered the body of Reshma from her house in Anaparthur on Wednesday.

Special teams were formed to trace the suspect, Venkatesh, who had fled to Bengaluru. He was arrested there, brought to Chennai, and then interrogated.

Venkatesh allegedly told the police that he had been in love with Reshma before she married another man about 10 years ago. The couple had two children.

Police say he stabbed her after she refused to accompany him to Bengaluru

Despite her marriage, Venkatesh continued to visit her and maintain their relationship. The police said she was pregnant with his child.

According to investigators, Venkatesh had visited Reshma a day before the murder and insisted that she leave with him for Bengaluru so they could live together. When she refused, he left but returned the following morning. Reshma then allegedly used pepper spray to send him away.

Enraged at this, Venkatesh stabbed her multiple times with a knife, killing her on the spot. He then fled to Bengaluru by flight.

ARCHIVAL RESEARCH AND IDENTIFICATION WORKS

E-Tender Notice No. GEM/2026/B/7711041 Dated: 25-06-2026.

Works tenders through "E" Tendering system for and on behalf of the president of India are invited for the works as detailed below:-

Name of work: Archival Research and Identification of Land Associated with Darjeeling Himalayan Railway (DHR)/ Cart Road in Compliance with CCMP, ICOMOS, WHC Reports/Guidelines. **Tender Value:** ₹1,12,10,000/-. **Earnest Money:** ₹2,06,050/-. **Date & time of Closing of tender:** At 15.00 hrs. & opening at 15.30 hrs. on 16-07-2026. The complete information with tender documents of above e-tender will be available in the website <https://Gem.gov.in>

Director/DHR/Kurseong

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E-Procurement Tender Notice No.: R2_Outsourcing_TMachines; Date: 25-06-2026. E-tenders are invited by the undersigned for the following works:

Tender No.: R2_Outsourcing_TMachines. **Name of work:** Outsourcing of Operation and Maintenance of 25 nos. Track Machines for a period of two years in Northeast Frontier Railway. Estimated Cost: ₹18,34,60,385.04/-; Earnest Money: ₹10,67,300.00. **E-tender will be closed at 15:00 hrs. on 17-07-2026.** The complete information along with the tender document of the above e-Tender will be available upto 14.30 hrs. of 17.07.2026 in the website www.ireps.gov.in

Deputy Chief Engineer/TMC, Malignaon

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Tender Notice No.: SA-M-DSL-ED-OT-26-27-2A

Dated: 25.06.2026

For and on behalf of the President of India the Senior Divisional Electrical Engineer, Loco Shed, Southern Railway, Salem Division, Erode - 638002 E-Tenders are invited for the following work:

Sl No.	Description	Details
1	Tender Notice Number and Date	SA-M-DSL-ED-OT-26-27-2A Dated: 25.06.2026
2	Name of the Work: Repairing & overhauling of IRAB 9/10 Tri plate panel of Electric locomotives at Southern Railway, Salem Division, Loco Shed, Erode.	Qty - 15 Nos.
3	Estimate Value	₹ 6475174/-
4	Tender Closing Date and Time	17.07.2026 at 15:00 hrs
5	Web address	https://www.ireps.gov.in

Complete details of the above tenders are given on the e-portal "www.ireps.gov.in" For Details of bid submission, please refer website portal "www.ireps.gov.in" For Details about scope of work, approximate value of tender, location and other documents, please refer website portal "www.ireps.gov.in"

The online bids for tenders floated through the above portal are required to be digitally signed

Senior Divisional Electrical Engineer (Rolling Stock) / Loco Shed / Erode

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Notice inviting Electronic Tenders

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e-Tender Notice No. 13 ET/2026-27

SN	Tender No.	Description	Qty.	Tender closing date
1	21261154	Pressure Sensor Oil Circuit Transformer	422 Nos.	03.08.2026*
2	02261080	Rotor (Scheme-1)	437 Nos.	23.07.2026*
3	20261120	Waterless Urinal System for WAP-7	41 Nos.	20.07.2026
4	11255349A	Transformer Oil Filtration Plant 5000 LPH	01 Nos.	10.07.2026
5	21261071	Axle Box Bearing	1303 Nos.	31.07.2026**
		Suspension Tube Bearing	910 Sets	
6	11261003	Bench Drilling Machine	38 Nos.	20.07.2026
7	02261088	POLYIMIDE PAPER (NOMEX)	1618 Kgs.	13.07.2026

Non V/D item
Above tender has been published on IREPS on 19/06/2026.
Tender closing Time 15:00 Hrs
Item marked with * is reserved for procurement from CLW approved sources.
**** is reserved for procurement from RDSO approved sources.**
The prospective Tenderers are advised to visit the website <http://www.ireps.gov.in> or <http://www.plw.indianrailways.gov.in> for detailed description of items & other terms and conditions of tender document. Please note that Tenderers can submit their quotations only through <http://www.ireps.gov.in>.

Corrigendum to e-Tender Notice No. 09 ET/2026-27
Closing date of Tender No. 20261116 may be read as 30.06.2026.

Corrigendum to e-Tender Notice No. 06 ET/2026-27
1) Closing date of Tender No. 20261066 may be read as 10.07.2026.
2) Closing date of Tender No. 20261099 may be read as 07.07.2026, and Qty may be read as 121 Nos.

Corrigendum to e-Tender Notice No. 08 ET/2026-27
Closing date of Tender No. 02261032 may be read as 14.07.2026

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Today 4 p.m at R.K. Swamy auditorium Mylapore Bharathanatyam by Kum. R SREE VARSHINI & Kum. R SREE SHIVANI (Dis of Smt Chitra Rajakamal) 5:30 p.m Bharathanatyam by Kum ADYA APPA-SWAMY (USA) (Dis of Smt Raji Krishna) 7:pm Bharathanatyam by Smt BHARATHI THAMIZHSELVAN, Smt. ARCHANA HARIBABU & Smt. NITHYA VIVEK(Dis of Dr. Archana Mahesh).

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From Page One

MDMK cuts ties with DMK, backs TVK govt.

Against this backdrop, a vast majority of party executives expressed their unwillingness to continue the partnership, formalising the exit. “Everyone who spoke at the general council advocated for leaving the DMK alliance,” Mr. Vaiko stated, adding that the final decision was unanimous.

Reflecting on their nine-year-long steadfast commitment to the DMK alliance, Mr. Vaiko said leaders from various parties, including the CPI(M) and IUML, had exposed backroom arrangements to help the AIADMK form the government. “If that had happened, there could not have been a bigger ‘political fraud’,” Mr. Vaiko remarked.

Significantly, both of the MDMK’s sitting MLAs R. Senthilselvan (Sirkazhi) and T.M. Rajendran (Kadayanallur) were conspicuously absent from the high-level meeting. When questioned about their absence, Mr. Vaiko clarified that Mr. Senthilselvan had already stated he had joined the DMK, while Kadayanallur MLA Mr. Rajendran had indicated that he would continue to remain with the party. Mr. Vaiko also revealed that during a meeting with Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay, the latter had promised to personally campaign for the MDMK if the two MLAs resigned to trigger byelections. However, Mr. Vaiko said the MLAs had refused to resign.

Explaining the party’s pivot toward the TVK, Mr. Vaiko said the MDMK chose to support Mr. Vijay’s government because it operated free of “corruption and commission” and firmly adhered to the foundational principles of socio-political leader C.N. Annadurai.

Having left the DMK alliance, Mr. Vaiko said they would extend their support to the TVK government. He added that they would not contest the byelections but would support the TVK instead, and their future actions would be geared toward forming a friendship with the TVK for the local body elections. Notably, the party’s principal secretary Durai Vaiko was also absent from Saturday’s meeting. Mr. Vaiko explained that Mr. Durai Vaiko had to travel to visit an unwell acquaintance.

Manickam Tagore is new TNCC president

A three-time MP and Rahul loyalist, his appointment comes after the Congress left the DMK alliance to join the TVK-led State government

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Three-time Lok Sabha member and Rahul Gandhi loyalist B. Manickam Tagore was appointed president of the Tamil Nadu Congress Committee (TNCC) on Saturday. The All India Congress Committee (AICC) made the decision after K. Selvaperunthagai requested AICC president Mallikarjun Kharge to relieve him as the TNCC chief.



B. Manickam Tagore

riod for the TNCC marked by internal squabbles. Public remarks by leaders had threatened to disrupt the alliance with the DMK in the Assembly election.

Party sources said that Mr. Selvaperunthagai could not enlist the support of party colleagues during his tenure and that his removal was widely expected after TNCC vice-president A. Gopanna wrote to AICC leaders about Mr. Selvaperunthagai’s recent interview, in which he attacked the TVK government and Mr. Vijay.

Mr. Tagore was elected to the Lok Sabha from the Virudhunagar constituency for the first time in 2009, and later in 2019 and 2024. He is presently the whip of the Congress in the Lok Sabha. He is also the

A vocal critic of the DMK, he had called for ‘share in power’, thus causing friction in his party’s alliance with the DMK

AICC in-charge of Andhra Pradesh and the Andaman and Nicobar Islands, State Selection Committee Observer of Haryana, and a Member of the Parliamentary Housing and Urban Affairs Committee and the Committee on Welfare of Other Backward Classes.

Mr. Tagore joined the National Students Union of India (NSUI) – the student wing of the Congress – in 1994. In 1998, he became its national president. He also held the post of national general secretary of the Indian Youth Congress between 2002-05 and served as election commissioner of the IYC in 2008.

Extending his wishes to the new TNCC chief, Mr. Selvaperunthagai said, “I extend my heartfelt wishes to Manickam Tagore who has been appointed as president of TNCC. Wishing you success and continued service towards welfare of the people.”

June to end on wet note as scattered showers likely to continue across State



Respite from heat: North Tamil Nadu districts, including Chennai and its neighbouring districts, Vellore, Tirupattur, and Ranipet, may receive moderate rainfall on Sunday. C. VENKATACHALAPATHY

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Scattered rainfall, which may be heavy in some districts, is likely to continue till the end of June, while near-normal temperatures are expected to prevail across Tamil Nadu. June may end on a wet note, with the State likely to record surplus rainfall.

The Regional Meteorological Centre has forecast that light to moderate rainfall would continue over the State, Puducherry and Karaikal area till Tuesday. North Tamil Nadu districts, including Chennai and its neighbouring districts, Vellore, Tirupattur and Ranipet, may experience rainfall of moderate intensity on Sunday. Gusty winds with speeds reaching 40-50 kmph would prevail.

Western Ghats districts, including the Nilgiris and Theni, may receive heavy rainfall on Sunday. Similar weather pattern may continue on Monday as well. Officials of the RMC said the prevailing weather systems would keep the maximum temperatures near normal in the State till the month-end.

V.R. Durai, Head, Regional Weather Forecasting Centre, RMC, said an upper air circulation over west-central Bay of Bengal would influence wet weather over the State.

Moreover, a trough along the north coastal T.N. would also trigger rainfall for a few days. However, there may be a drop in rainfall after June 30.

Cloud cover is expected to keep daytime temperatures near normal over the next few days. The southwest monsoon has been in its normal phase in the State. Most districts have received their normal share or surplus rainfall so far this June.

The State has recorded an overall rainfall of 67 mm – 44% more than its seasonal average since June 1. Districts, including Chennai, Chengalpattu, Nilgiris and Tirupattur, have recorded a rainfall deficit, he said.

Arlekar, Vijay, and other leaders condole death of actor-filmmaker Bhagyaraj

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Condolences poured in from film and political personalities in Tamil Nadu for actor-director K. Bhagyaraj, who passed away at the age of 73 following a heart attack on Saturday.

“The passing away of veteran Tamil film director and writer Thiru. K. Bhagyaraj is a great loss to the world of cinema,” wrote Governor Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar on X. “His unique storytelling, creative brilliance, and immense contribution to Tamil cinema have earned him a special place in the hearts of audiences. His legacy will continue to inspire generations of filmmakers and film lovers. I extend my heartfelt condolences to his family, friends, and countless admirers. May his soul rest in peace,” he said.

Announcing that Bhagyaraj will be laid to rest with full State honours, Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay, in a post on X, said: “Through films that reflect unique storytelling, humour-infused performances, and the profound emotions of rural life and family relationships, Thiru. K. Bhagyaraj has carved an everlasting place in the hearts of Tamil people. His contributions to the Tamil film world are immeasurable.”

“Each of his creations will endure forever as timeless memories that entertain while speaking to humanity and social values. His demise is an irreplaceable loss to Tamil cinema. I convey my deepest condolences and sympathies to his grieving family, relatives, friends, members of the film industry, and fans. I pray that his soul rests in peace at the divine feet of

the Lord,” Mr. Vijay wrote.

‘A realistic hero’

Former Chief Minister and DMK president M.K. Stalin, referring to legendary Tamil film director and actor Bharathiraja who passed away earlier this month, said: “Within just a few weeks of the teacher’s passing, the Tamil film world has now lost his student as well!”

“In Indian cinema, as the emperor of unfinished screenplays, as the realistic hero who captivated everyone, as a writer endowed with the ability to navigate complex situations with brief dialogues, and as an extraordinary director who triumphed in every aspect, Bhagyaraj made his mark,” Mr. Stalin said in a post on X.

Expressing shock and sadness, AIADMK general secretary Edappadi K. Palaniswami hailed Bhagyaraj as a multifaceted personality and a unique screenplay writer. He recalled that the relationship between AIADMK founder and former Chief Minister M.G. Ramachandran and Bhagyaraj was based on mutual affection.

Union Minister of State for Information and Broadcasting and Parliamentary Affairs L. Murugan said: “Having recently completed his 50-year landmark journey in the film industry and being specially praised by members of the film world and fans alike, his demise is an irreplaceable loss to the Tamil film industry.”

MP Kanimozhi Karunanidhi said through his immensely popular films, he left an indelible mark on Tamil cinema and made significant contributions to the industry over a career spanning five decades. DMK MP Thamizhachi Thangapandian said Bhagyaraj, through his various creations, carved a niche for himself in Tamil cinema.

BJP State president Nainar Nagenthiran, expressing his condolences, said, “His works continue to serve as exemplary lessons even today on how the screenplay of a film should be structured. By seamlessly blending simple narratives, humour, family sentiments, and engaging screenplays in his distinctive style, he has gifted Tamil cinema with timeless creations that will endure for countless generations.”

MP and VCK founder-president Thol. Thirumavalavan described Bhagyaraj as a towering figure in the world of cinema. “AIADMK founder and former Chief Minister M.G. Ramachandran referred to him as his ‘film heir’. He earned the reputation of being one of the finest screenplay writers. Many would look forward to his films,” he said.

Naam Tamilar Katchi (NTK) chief coordinator Seeman said: “Bhagyaraj was an encyclopedia in screenplay. The films he took, the subjects he touched upon, and his screenplays were welcomed by audiences. Bhagyaraj was the first student of the legendary director K. Bharathiraja and he gave several hit films, and touched phenomenal heights.”

Actor Chiranjeevi, in a post, said he was deeply shocked and heartbroken beyond words.

‘Unique creative vision’

Kerala Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan too said he was deeply saddened by the passing of Bhagyaraj. “Revered as the ‘Screenplay King’, he redefined storytelling in Tamil cinema with his unique creative vision and unforgettable performances. He also shared a special bond with Malayalam cinema – his memorable role in *Mr. Marumakan* continues to be fondly remembered by fans in Kerala,” Mr. Satheesan said. Former Kerala Chief Minister Pinarayi Vijayan said he left a unique mark in the Tamil film world and earned the love of Malayalis through his excellent creations. “His demise is an irreplaceable loss to the film industry and the cultural sector,” he said.

Other leaders, including actor and MNM chief Kamal Haasan, DMDK MLA Premallatha Vijayakant, MP D. Ravikumar, former BJP State president K. Annamalai, TMCM(M) president G.K. Vasan, and AMMK general secretary T.T.V. Dhinakaran, condoled Bhagyaraj’s death.



DMK president M.K. Stalin pays tribute to the mortal remains of late film director and actor K. Bhagyaraj, at his residence in Chennai. PTI



People taking out a march for the late actor at Vellankovil.

Vellankovil residents pay their respects to Bhagyaraj

The Hindu Bureau
ERODE

More than 300 residents of Vellankovil, near Gobichettipalayam, took out a silent procession on Saturday to pay homage to actor-director K. Bhagyaraj, who passed away on Saturday.

The filmmaker was born and brought up in Vellankovil. The procession was organised by villagers and his childhood friends. Participants, wearing black badges and carrying candles, paid floral tributes to a portrait of Bhagyaraj at Anna Thidal before beginning the procession.

Politics, an arena where the versatile Bhagyaraj could not make a dent

T. Ramakrishnan
CHENNAI

Veteran film director K. Bhagyaraj had once tried his hand in politics but, despite being known as the “film heir” of AIADMK founder and former Chief Minister M.G. Ramachandran (MGR), he could not come to terms with the rough and tumble of politics.

As a devout follower of MGR, Bhagyaraj was naturally associated with the AIADMK. While launching a Tamil newspaper in January 1984, MGR called Bhagyaraj his *kalai ulaga vaarisu* (successor in the world of arts). A few weeks later, MGR attended Bhagyaraj and Poornima’s wedding. All this gave Bhagyaraj considerable mileage.

At the time of the AIADMK’s first split in 1988, he sided with the Janaki Ramachandran faction. After the AIADMK (Janaki Ramachandran) group fared poorly in the Assembly election in January 1989, Bhagyaraj left the party and launched the MGR Makkal Munnetra Kazhagam the next month, purportedly to “carry on the legacy of MGR” by dovetailing his fan clubs with those of MGR supporters.

Supporting the DMK

Later that year, when the Lok Sabha election took place, the MGR Makkal Munnetra Kazhagam supported the DMK-led front.

After realising that his solo performance did not yield dividends, he re-



K. Bhagyaraj receiving the Kalaimamani award from Tamil Nadu Chief Minister M.G. Ramachandran on January 26, 1984. MGR had called him his “*kalai ulaga vaarisu*”. THE HINDU ARCHIVES

turned to the AIADMK.

In April 2006, on the eve of the Assembly election, Bhagyaraj, after meeting DMK president M. Karunanidhi, joined the party. At that time, he told this newspaper that as a supporter of the AIADMK, he had thought that Jayalalithaa was the “fittest person” to lead the country. But after she launched a personal attack on some national leaders, he decided to keep away from politics.

His decision to join the Dravidian major was because only the DMK-led front could “fulfil people’s aspirations and take the State forward.”

In April 2022, Bhagyaraj participated in the launch of a publication on the welfare policies of Prime Minister Narendra Modi at the State BJP headquarters. His remarks at the event triggered a row and he later expressed regret.

The story behind *Bhagya*

K. Muralitharan
CHENNAI

While actively working in the film industry, K. Bhagyaraj also harboured a strong desire to run a weekly variety magazine. During the filming of *Idhu Namma Aalu*, he launched a variety magazine named *Bhagya*, appointing his friend Sanjeevi to manage its operations. The inaugural issue featured a photograph of his children on the cover.

The core objective of *Bhagya* was to entertain its readers. In line with this, the magazine featured simple modern poetry (*Puthu Kavithaigal*), short stories, and photo-caption commentaries.

However, the most critical and successful feature of the magazine was its ‘Q&A Section’.

Questions would pour in for this segment, where Bhagyaraj directly answered the queries of readers, recalls N.S. Nana, who served as the chief design-



A leisurely read: The magazine featured simple modern poetry, short stories, and photo-caption commentaries. N.S. NANA

er during the magazine’s initial days. “The director would arrive at the magazine office on Sundays specifically for the Q&A Section. He would sift through the received questions to choose the ones that could be answered interestingly and would dictate the replies in his signature style. On certain occasions, he would already have some interesting anecdotes in mind, and

questions would be tweaked to fit them,” says Mr. Nana.

Mr. Nana also notes that Bhagyaraj wrote the editorials for the magazine entirely by hand. Just as in his movies, some of the humour snippets published in this magazine were also adult-oriented. According to Mr. Nana, the magazine had a print run of approximately 1,00,000 copies during its initial days.

INBRIEF



Madras West Round Table 10 hosts Unified Sports Carnival

Madras West Round Table 10 (MWRTO), hosted the 30th edition of the Unified Sports Carnival 2026 at the ICF Indoor Stadium in Ayanavaram, continuing a tradition that began in 1996. This year too, nearly 1,000 children with intellectual and developmental disabilities participated in sports, games, and recreational activities with mainstream school children. The organising team said, “The Unified Sports Carnival is a celebration of acceptance, dignity, and human connection. For thirty years, we have witnessed barriers dissolve when children come together on the same playground.” Chief Guest, actor Harshath Khan, leaders from Round Table India and Ladies Circle India attended the event.

Mahaveer Ashray Hospice marks nine years of service

Mahaveer Ashray Hospice, the hospice facility of Cancer Institute (WIA), Adyar, celebrated nine years of service and marked the beginning of its tenth year at its Sriperumbudur campus on Saturday. The celebration is being held in the centenary year of V. Shanta, honouring her vision of compassionate and patient-centred care. According to a press release, it is a 60-bed, stand-alone hospice that provides comprehensive palliative and end-of-life care free of charge to patients with advanced stages of cancer.

‘Gateway of Chennai’ project set to beautify stretch from Airport to Kathipara flyover

The project will provide modern city-scaping elements along the 4.8-km stretch; initial survey has started and meeting of senior officials has been scheduled next week to discuss the project

STORIES FROM THE ROAD

Aloysius Xavier Lopez
CHENNAI

The Greater Chennai Corporation (GCC) will turn the 4.8 km stretch from Airport to Kathipara flyover into the “Gateway of Chennai” and provide modern city-scaping elements along the stretch.

Initial survey has started and a meeting of senior officials has been scheduled next week to discuss all aspects of the project. Land acquisition may not be required for the project. The project involves landscape architecture and beautification with native flowering plants, shrubs and trees, better lighting without affecting air traffic.

Two parks along the stretch will receive a makeover as part of the works. A park which is owned by the Corporation along the stretch and another park owned by the Highways



Urban gateway: The project involves beautification with native flowering plants, shrubs and trees, better lighting. FILE PHOTO

Department will receive a makeover, officials said. The key aspects of the project will be finalised next week. K.P. Subramanian, former professor of Urban Engineering, Anna University, said: “The elements of the urban design project may include among others a distinctive welcoming flex boards depicting the inspiring Tamil culture, classical art, and the heritages of the city.”

The streetscape design components such as aesthetic sign boards, elegant

road markings, street furniture, bus shelters with modern design, footpaths, and cycle tracks, follow a common design language. The features of landscaping are similar to native shade trees, seasonal flowering trees, plants, shrubs, and green medians, he said.

K. Kumar, visiting faculty, SAP, Anna University and former Chief Planner, CMDA, said: “The idea of making the transit from the Chennai airport to the city centre pleasant and at-

tractive to the visitors is worthwhile provided everything else is in order.”

Mr. Kumar said, “The purpose of the very idea hinges heavily on the prospective international visitors to the Chennai. That the airport is already on the brink of over-saturation of capacity has forced many airlines to shift their operation to the neighbouring airports at Bengaluru or Hyderabad. What has added fuel to the fire is all the serious efforts made in the last 15 years to expand the capacity to the existing airport or developing a second green-field airport have fallen through.”

Unless and until the airport is attractive enough, neither global direct investments nor foreign tourists would make a beeline to Chennai. “The alternative site for the second international airport is not yet ready and the long gestational time needed before its commissioning militate against the idea of beautifying the airport travel corridor,” he noted.



Sashi Kumar releasing Asan Coffee Table Book at an event in Asan Memorial School in Chennai on Saturday. B. VELANKANNI RAJ

Education must mean acquiring wisdom, says Sashi Kumar

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Education must mean acquiring, not knowledge and information anymore, but wisdom,” said Sashi Kumar, chairman of Asian College of Journalism at the Diamond Jubilee Valedictory event held at Asan Senior Secondary School in Chennai on Saturday.

Releasing the Asan Coffee Table Book, he said, “This stays with you because you can adjust your personality, mental abilities to understand context and perspectives that evolve in a fast-changing world. The human capacity to understand and cope with this is going to be a big challenge.”

Noting social media is a space where everybody interacts, he said that it is also rife with a lot of disinformation

and misinformation. “It’s a dangerous space for young vulnerable minds. Many countries today have decided to keep social media away for children below 16 years of age. This is another area that needs serious thought,” he said.

General secretary of Asan Memorial Association Shyamala Jayaprakash said that alongside traditional schooling, the school also embraced vocational education as practical skills are as essential as exams and debates.

The coffee table book released on the occasion chronicled the 60 years of the institution.

President of the association C.K. Revi and other members also spoke on the occasion. Alumni, teachers and students of the institution were also present.

Soumya Swaminathan honoured as Super Chennai’s ‘Icon of the Month’

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Scientist and Chairperson of the M.S. Swaminathan Research Foundation (MSSRF), Soumya Swaminathan was presented with Super Chennai’s ‘Icon of the Month’ award on Saturday, in recognition of her contributions to science and public health.

The award was presented by Ranjeeth Rathod, Managing Director of Super Chennai, and Chella Krishna, Partner, SRSV & Associates, after Dr. Swaminathan’s conversation with Akhila Krishnamurthy at Super Chennai Arattai. During the discussion, Dr. Swaminathan spoke about artificial intelligence in healthcare, lessons from the COVID-19 pandemic,



Soumya Swaminathan receiving the award at Super Chennai Arattai event in Chennai on Saturday. R. RAVINDRAN

and the importance of empathy in science.

Speaking on the growing role of artificial intelligence in healthcare, she said technology should be deployed to improve health outcomes and make healthcare delivery more efficient, rather than increase the burden on frontline workers. Referring to

healthcare staff who are often required to enter the same information in both physical registers and digital applications, she said digitalisation would be meaningful only if it streamlined workflows.

Dr. Swaminathan said the COVID-19 pandemic showcased unprecedented scientific collaboration,

with researchers across disciplines openly sharing data to accelerate understanding of the virus. At the same time, it exposed deep inequities, with poorer countries receiving vaccines much later and vulnerable communities bearing the brunt of job losses, food insecurity, and prolonged school closures, she said.

Drawing from her early work on tuberculosis and HIV in Chennai, Dr. Swaminathan said these experiences reinforced the need for an interdisciplinary approach, with social scientists working alongside clinicians and researchers. She said that while her father taught patience, her mother instilled the courage to speak up for what she believed in.

Man arrested for allegedly cheating private schools of over ₹100 crore

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Central Crime Branch (CCB) of the Greater Chennai Police, on Saturday, arrested B.T. Arasakumar, 59, who has been running an unregistered association of private schools.

He was arrested for allegedly cheating private school managements across the State of more than ₹100 crore by promising to secure government approvals and recognition

for their institutions. The police said the accused allegedly operated the unregistered organisation under the name of ‘Tamil Nadu Private Schools Association’ and claimed to have political and bureaucratic influence to obtain permanent recognition, school upgradation, DTCP/ CMDA approvals, and other statutory clearances for private schools.

According to the police, the case was registered following a complaint filed by

Ilangovan, secretary of the Federation of Associations of Private Schools in Tamil Nadu. The complainant alleged that over the past two years, several private school managements facing difficulties in obtaining approvals were induced to pay large sums of money after Arasakumar assured them that he would secure the required clearances.

The police said the accused neither obtained the promised approvals nor returned the money.

Based on the complaint, the Central Crime Branch registered a case and launched an investigation.

Acting on the directions of Chennai Police Commissioner A. Amalraj, a special team from the Economic Documents Fraud Wing, led by Assistant Commissioner V.E. Senthil, arrested Arasakumar on Saturday.

The accused would be produced before the court after interrogation, the police said.

Toll in Tiruvallur factory ammonia leak rises to 16

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The death of another woman took the toll in the ammonia gas leak at a seafood processing and export facility in Tiruvallur district to 16 on Saturday,

according to a bulletin issued by the Health Department.

The deceased was identified as Kabita Juanga of Odisha.

At present, 26 persons – 25 women and one man – are undergoing treatment.

WESTERN RAILWAY - AHMEDABAD
ENGAGEMENT OF DETAILED DESIGN CONSULTANT
E-TENDER NOTICE No. Dy.CE/(C)III/ADI/SEJ-DSIR/DDC/01
Dy. Chief Engineer (Construction)-SHSR, Western Railway, Ahmedabad for and on behalf of President of Union of India issued E-Tender Notice as under: (1) Name of work with its location: Tender No. Dy.CE/(C)III/ADI/SEJ-DSIR/DDC/01: Engagement of Detailed Design Consultant (DDC) for Construction of New BG Double line between Sarkhej to Dholera (109.16 Kms) with Spur lines to Lothal NMHC and Dholera International Airport. Total Length: 134.06 Kms in the Jurisdiction of Chief Administrative Officer (Construction), Ahmedabad of Western Railway. (2) Approx. cost of the work: ₹ 22.04,87,541.00 (3) Earnest money to be deposited: ₹ 44,09,800.00 (4) Completion Period: 48 (Forty Eight) Months. Bid Due date: 22-07-2026 at 15.00 Hrs. (5) Physical submission of Original BG of Bid Security: upto 21-07-2026 upto 18.00 Hrs., Opening of Technical Bid: 22-07-2026 at 15.30 Hrs., Pre-Bid Conference: 03-07-2026 at 12.00 Hrs., System of Tender: Two Packet System & Website particulars Notice Board location where complete details of tender can be seen & address of the office: Web Site: www.reps.gov.in Office of Dy. Chief Engineer (Construction)SHSR, Western Railway, 1st Floor, "C" Wing, Nirman Bhavan, Opp. GCS Hospital, Asarva, Ahmedabad-382345. CPM-020
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NOTIFICATION No.03/CICT/Professor/2026-2027
Date:28.06.2026
Central Institute of Classical Tamil, Chennai (CICT) invites applications from Indian Nationals, who fulfill the prescribed qualification, experience, age and other conditions as per the UGC Regulations for filling up the following posts sanctioned on regular basis, as per the details given below:-

S.No	Name of the Post	Academic Level	No. of Post	Category	Method of Recruitment
1.	Associate Professor	Level 13A of 7 th CPC as per UGC	06	UR-5 OBC-1	Direct

The details of the posts, educational qualification, age, experience and application format are available in the Institute’s website www.cict.in. Applications complete in all aspects along with requisite application fee and all necessary documents should reach within 60 days of publication of this advertisement to “The Registrar, Central Institute of Classical Tamil, Chemmozhi Salai, Perumbakkam, Chennai-600100”.
Sd/-
Registrar

HPV vaccine awareness rally held

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Kancheepuram Obstetric and Gynaecological Society (KOGS), in support of Indian Medical Association, Tambaram Branch, organised a rally to raise awareness of the importance of the Human Papillomavirus (HPV) vaccine for girls aged below 14, in Tambaram on Saturday.

President of KOGS Umaiyal Murugesan spoke.

OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH
SAD DEMISE
Thiru. K. BHAGYARAJ
Director and Film Actor
Date of Demise: 27/06/2026
Well Wisher of
RAJAN EYE CARE
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Eyes Donated to
Rotary Rajan Eye Bank
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DEATH ANNIVERSARIES
2nd YEAR ANNIVERSARY
MANGALAM SRINIVASAN
W/o T. V. Srinivasan IAS (retd)
Fondly remembered by Family and Friends

4th ANNIVERSARY
Mrs. Margaret Mangaladurai
Retd. Physical Directress, Stella Maris College
W/o Mr. A.D. Mangaladurai
DOB: 30.09.1929 DOD: 28.06.2022
Remembered by loving Family Members

OBITUARY
Moti Soli Daruwala
(1931-2026)
Co-founder-Sarala's Art Centre, Chennai. Estb: 1965
Passed away on 23 June 2026.
Fondly remembered by the family, who pray for her peaceful onward journey.

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BRIDEGROOMS WANTED

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BIHARI
Bihari Rajput Family settled in Hyderabad invites alliance for Daughter, 32Yrs / 152.5 cm, B.A. LL.B (Hons), M.A. (Psychology), Counselor, Father retired Central Govt. Class-I Officer, Mother Homemaker, elder sister settled in Hyderabad. Seeking well-educated, cultured Groom from respectable Rajput/ Bhumihar/ Kayastha/ Brahmin Family. Contact: 9711184100

COSMOPOLITAN
SUITABLE GROOM sought for our daughter, a well-educated professional in her late twenties, working in the UK. Looking for a well-settled groom (30/33 years) with progressive values, an egalitarian outlook, and free from rigid patriarchal or caste-hierarchical beliefs. Mob:9840993455

WANTED GROOM
Balija Naidu Bride,
Chennai - Born, 32, 5'7",
Fair, Qualification:
IIM (Calcutta) - PG Dip.
in Digital Marketing,
well-settled family seeks
educated, cultured groom
from a suitable family
Contact:
9769263777
balajilenka@gmail.com

WANTED GROOM
Tall, Elegant,
Dr. from Biz Family
'93 Born, 5'5", M.D.,
High Profile, Cultured &
Respectable
Family looking for
an equal Match.

SUDHIR BHATT.
9920099889 / 9619101019 / 20
sudhirmatrim@gmail.com
HINDU.50YR ISSUELESS divorcee ACS working MNC seeks issueless groom CNB. 8778873501
Groom required for a Girl 32 yrs old, M.Tech from IIT Chennai, working in Chennai driving 30 L / years, from Kerala SC, Vishakam. Contact whatsapp 9447763685.

COSMOPOLITAN

QUALIFIED GIRL, well educated abroad, 1990/165cm (Hindu), father cardiologist, seeks qualified groom, open to all backgrounds, Indian/NRIs, Contact: 9266863038

DOCTOR

VANIYAR 31, MBBS/ MS, Midhunam, Thiruvadurai, Slim seeks MBBS/ MS Doctor Groom only. Contact: 9444259255
DOCTOR MD, DM, Salary 3 Lakhs pm, 1992/155cm Hindu (BC) Girl, fair, slim, cultured family, well settle in Bangalore, upper middle class seeks bridegroom MD/MS/DM or suitably qualified engineer with good salary, caste no bar. Contact: 9845522122
KONGU VELLALAR Gounder Othala Kootam Anusham Viruchigam Girl 26/ 165 Studying MD, seeks MD/MS same caste. Whatsapp only 9025823332/ No Broker

ALLIANCE INVITED for my daughter born in Dec 93 fair 160 CM completed MS General Surgery and now doing Mch Neuro Surgery 3rd year from Doctors with PG or suitably qualified from Mudaliar/ Vellalar Contact 9444012939.

STUDYING IN chennai MD(Gen Med) first year girl, Mudaliyar family, magaram/Avittam, Nonveg, DOB 9jan2000/23.47. Expecting grooms MD/MS completed or studying, only medical grooms only contact 9840909460

GOVT / QUASI GOVT

BRIDE GROOM WANTED
Hindu Nadar 26 yrs,
168 cm, Civil Judge
Seeks Bridegroom
Below 30 yrs from
Same Profession /
Group I / Group II
Officer in
Tamilnadu Only.
9710209761, 9840425972

KANNADA

SEEKING A well-educated groom (Kannada/Tamil speaking) for a Kannada Smartha Brahmin girl (MBA, born 1990, divorced, no issues). Proposals from divorced, unmarried, or widower (without issues) grooms settled in Bangalore, within the age of 37 to 40 years welcome. Contact Phone Number: 8105404780

MALAYALAM

HINDU NADAR girl, 30, Govt. Agriculture Officer seeks suitable groom. Caste no bar. Contact: 9495036447.

EZHAVA GIRL, White Fair, 23, Bharani, 168 cm, B.Tech. EEE. Contact: 9495245179, 8848862175.

THIYYA GIRL, 24/160cm. B.E., working in MNC. Seeking a suitable, qualified groom, same caste. Contact 9789084177

✓ **ALLIANCE INVITED** for Hindu Ezhava girl, 28 years, MBBS, 152 cm, Ennakulam. Seeking professionally qualified Hindu Ezhava groom from a respectable family. Contact:9544589706.

NAIR DOCTOR Girl DM 32 Yrs 161 Cm seeks Doctor professional. Mob : 8089 584220, 9249 920550.

NRI

30 Years/175 cm, Employed in Canada, Divorced, looking for a Genuine understanding life Partner. Contact 93810 57689

TAMIL

TAMIL MUSLIM girl 32/158cm, AYB/Principles Product Engineer, MNC, 34LPA, well-settled family, seeks Tamil speaking never married groom with similar bg. Ct. 63832 76233

NATHAMAR UDAYAR, catholic, 1993 borned, HR professional-MNC , with null and void order looking for Christian yrs below 35 yrs, open, Emekulam. Seeking IT professional with legal, church orders with clean habits, WhatsAp 9940099429

CHRISTIAN CSI, Doctor, looking for same profession groom in any caste, settled or working in USA, UK, Canada and Australia from 24-29. 8138900652

CSI, ADIDRAVIDAR, B.Tech, Government staff, searching for a groom in Qatar from 28-31 in equal caste. 8137003550

CSI, ROYALE profile, BE, Business, seeking for a Rich/affluent man in CSI or Christian nadar. 8138900487

UDAYAR CHRISTIAN, 32, divorced, UK, looking for a Rich/affluent groom from 31-36 from Hindu or Christian. 8137001257

✓ **PARENTS OF** Tamil Muslim doctor girl doing MD and Residenship in govt medical college, 27yrs, 160cm, smart, reputed family, seeks matching proposal from parents of doctor only. 9489465536 / 6381615274

CHRISTIAN, PILLAI, 36/M.Sc., M.Phil, Asst.Prof. Pondy,Seeks Groom FC/BC, below 39yrs. Ct: 98946-77892.

CHRISTIAN/ VELLALAR/ 26/ B.E, M.E., looking for professional grooms in Chennai. Ct: 9444468802

CHRISTIAN (BC) Girl, 36/172, B.Tech, MBA, Strategy Consultant at a MNC based in Chennai. Seeking a suitable Christian Groom with good family values. Caste no bar. Ct: 8778907487

PILLAI/MUDALIAR PROF quid working Groom wanted for Hastham 38, fair MCA Chennai.8220757159/ 9444136336

SEEKING GRADUATE/PROFESSIONAL for 44yrs unmarried Tamil SC Hindu Ad, Dravidia Female IT professional (20yrs exp) from Chennai holding Singapore PR. Contact +919790921761/+91 7200942776.

LOOKING for Bridegroom for 28 yrs smart Girl, (Nadar) MBA from NUS Singapore, not particular about Horoscope. Broad Minded with Modern outlook. What'sapp details to: 93421 04357

TAMIL

Hindu Agamudaiyar, 1997, MS (USA) serving in the EU, seeks suitable and Qualified Groom. 942614293

MUDALIAR 29 165cm BE MBA Chennai seeks professional Handsome Mudaliar Pillai Grooms Geetham 9884858014

VALLUVAN 40/160 BE Remarriage 2 Daughters Kerala seeks Educated Broad Minded Groom CNB Geetham 9884858014

MUDALIAR 40/163 BE MBA Phd doing Madurai seeks Educated Employed Mudaliar Pillai Groom Geetham 9884858014

GROOM WANTED CNB,26yrs, MBBS, MD, Running schools & Institutions in ChennaiPh: 6385293227

MUDALIYAR DOCTOR MS Ophthalmologist 35/165 Fair Chennai seeks well educated good family groom. 9962830417

HINDU SC Arunthathiar Jana Kilai 38, Asst. Professor Rs.5 Lakh Per Annum 6379869610

INTERCASTE, M.TECH, Private, Ireland, looking for a 29-33 groom in European countries, rich/affluent any caste. 81389000575

ADIDRAVIDAR, CZECH republic, MS, looking for a same caste groom from 27-30 in rich/affluent. 7356483111

Tamil Iyengar Kausiga Uthram Doctor 29/165 working London seeks alliance from UK based Grooms. Contact: 9841031480 / 9444034369, Email Id: kodiyaalam@gmail.com

WELL Qualified Tamil Intercaste Parents seek alliance for their Software Engineer Daughter, 25 years,working in Bangalore.Looking for Professional working in India, Vegetarian, Teetotaler, non-smoker Caste no bar. Contact: 94446-42214.

HINDU MARAVAR PhD,32/155,divorced within a week.Seeking groom. 8643853147

HINDU VANNIYAR Girl May 1998, 162cm Kettai BE,Asst Manager Govt Bank. Seek Suitable Grooms.Ct: 9894128789

AGAMUDAYA MUDALIAR, Rich / affluent, MD, Fair, seeking for a suitable groom from equal caste in good looking from 27-31. 8138900412

DKV/SC, 32/ May 94, 167cm, Fair (CS), Parents Hindu / CSI, Seeks Groom Dr./Er. / Abroad. Ct:8056143638

HINDU MUDALIAR, 31 Age, 160cm, BE, Working in IT MNC 21 LPA, Seeks Suitable Groom CA, BE or Blech from Mudaliar or Sub Caste Call 7550251015

HINDU MARUTHUVAR well-educated, affluent family seeks suitable groom for their daughter, 26 years, Software Engineer, Currently in USA. Same community preferred. Others welcome. Ph. 9384816370

HINDU SC AD 26/151,MSc Thiruvonam Magaram Fair Good Looking Chennai. Seeks Govt /Pvt Employed Groom From Chennai Good Family Wh:9629412661

FASHION DESIGNER SaivaMudaliar Anusham 33 Very Fair Propertied NeedVeg IT/ Govt Employed Groom 9566286349

FAIR GOOD looking 26 yrs living at Chennai M.com(P.hd) working as Asst.Prof in pvt college 5.5ft (165cm) seeking pure vegetarian bridegroom of sozhiya vellalar/ any pillai with expectation of height 5.11 to 6 feet and fair, with age 3yrs difference chennai based with any profession. Contact 9445428534 / 9940338846

ALLIANCE FOR 26, Profits pursuing Ph.D in US seeks professionally qualified groom. Caste nobar. 8248569028

MUDALIAR PARENTS seek professional groom settled in UK for their daughter age 34 height 172 cm Revathi studied medicine in UK and working as surgeon. Ph: 9884452926

ISAIVELLALAR, MBBS Preparing for PG, May 98, Kruthigai, Mesham, Doctor Parents in Chennai, Seeks Suitable Groom Preferably Doctor. Caste no bar. Ct: 9003204007

VANNIYAR, RE Marriage, Age 30, Ayilam, Employed in Bank, Groom Needed from Thanjavur, Kumbakonam & Madras Area only. Cont: 9840961251

PILLAI 30/165CM BE Canada seeks IT professional Canadian P/R/Citizen only. Geetham 9884858014

HINDU, SC, 38 yrs, BE, MBA, 80,000 P/M, Divorcee, No Children, Looking for Groom in Chennai under 42 in a well settled Job 9840429449

HINDU VISHWAKARMA Goldsmith girl B.Pharm, working in PRS Hospital, 24, 156 cm, TVM, Ph: 9387820222.

HINDU NADAR- Divorcee Unconsummated Marriage - 35 JPMC IT, Bangalore Sr.Associate 40LPA Own House. Seeks bhw 38yr. Call / Wh : 94421 26378

HINDU CIVIL Servant (UPSC - IRMS /Southern Railway)Post in Chennai, 32/164cm, Fair, Natine: Tirunelveli, Mother: DRO - Revenue Dept. seeks Groom, well educated family with Civil Servant/ Medical/ Successful Entrepreneurs. Thevar/Caste no bar from equal community. Ct: 94878 35626

GROOM WANTED 25yr, Mudaliyar,M. Tech, Affluent Business family in Chennai Ph: 6385293227

MUDALIAR 26/160, Pretty MS, Logistics & Warehousing, AT0 15 Cr. Elite 100 Cr CNB. 9043991629, 9043987029

GROOM WANTED Hindu Nadar 26yrs,BE, MBA,SWE 1 L/p/m Elite Business Family Ph: 9841329471/9380791999

HINDU NADAR Affluent Business Family invites alliance for their daughter born in 1990/Fair/174 cm/ MSC graduate. Looking for educated well settled groom from same community in India. Please contact: vsr9026@gmail.com

MUDALIAR (BOC) Girl, 36/172, B.Tech, MBA, doing father Business, Chennai, Elite Family seeks groom Business / Doctor - 8925019776

28 NATTU Kottai Chettiyar BE Architect, Seeks Same Caste, Job/ Business Groom. Chennai. Ph: 9600057121 / sairamravi708@gmail.com

MUDHALIYAR, BE, Age 34, Ayilam, Never Married Woman in USA, Well Settled Seeks Groom from USA. 8754756329

Looking for Brahmin, non-Kaushika groom for lyer girl, 42/165, BE, MBA, earning 30 Lakhs pa. Contact: 9441243172

Vadaml-Girl 24 Yrs, Iyer Athreyam B.E Sr. Engineer TAFE Chennai. Contact: 9543411210 / 9894679685.

TAMIL

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MALAYALAM

MUSLIM GROOM, (34/182 cms), Slim/ fair from Calicut. B.Tech (Mech) MIT Manipal, MBA HEC Paris. Manager at McKinsey, Dubai. Seeking well-educated bride, preferably in Gulf. Contact: 9292012137, shk.yusuf99@gmail.com

CHENNAI SETTLED Nair Boy 29/173, BE, MBA, Mageeram Shudha Jagadham, Consultant in MNC Chennai. 9840838971

THIYYA 28/170CM B Tech, PGDPP 12L per annum Technical Expert Virtual Production Chennai Settled 9445421968

TAMIL

CHRISTIAN NADAR, Doctor, Divorcee 37yrs/178cm, MBBS, Dip in Cardiology better earning lives in Nagorecoil seeks qualified/ Divorced Bride. 9003983230

CHRISTIAN DOCTOR, 39/169, M.D. Paediatric, Neonatologist, Profession in Trivandrum, Fair, Handsome, Divorce - no kids, seeks Fair Doctor/ Non Medicob bride, age 30 to 35. Preferably South India. Caste no bar. 93420 06119, 94433 26119

TAMIL MUSLIM, 30/170, BE Mech, Asst Manager in Auto OEM, Chennai seeks Tamil Muslim bride, Ct: 9444297042

AGE-39, MBBS, MD, Well settled, Bangalore. CSI, Never married. Caste no Bar. 7305460763 / 8754756329

SC, CHRISTIAN, 30, M.Tech, Software Engineer working MNC Chennai, Salary Rs.75,000 pm, seeks suitable employed (either working in govt or MNC) Bride. CNB. Ct: 89391 77665

CSI CHRISTIAN Nadar Kanyakumary District, 27/168, MBBS, MD (Clinical Subject) seeks same sect Doctor PG/Entry (G.M) preferred. Send bio-data. 6381784394/ 9487452271.

TAMIL MUSLIM 28/182 MS Ortho Seeks prof qualified bride Ct : 8220042091 mdullahsafi@gmail.com

TAMIL YADAVA Boy, M.B.A, 38, Ayilam, System Eng. TCS, Chennai, Rs.60000/pm, Seeks Yadava bride within TN. Contact through Tamil. WhatsApp : 9966673354 / Cell :7373386474

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TAMIL

Hindu Valluvan 41yrs, MBA, IT, MNC Working, seeks Suitable Groom, CNB, First Marriage only. Ct: 98862 34181

Mudaliar 27/160/ Fair / Normal / MBA daughter of an affluent family looking for a Groom of Chennai based - 9600136660

Tamil SC Brides- 29 yrs, B.Tech, MBA, IT, 13 LPA & 26 yrs, B.Sc. Seeking suitable Grooms. Contact - 9441677205

B.ARCH State Govt. Girl 31/165cm Divorced No issues seeking handsome & qualid groom from good family. CNB. 94453954257/9498385494

SozhiaVellalar B Tech unmarried 40/155 officer PS Bank CNB Contact: 946899599

TELEGU

ANDHRA LADY Doctor, MD, 35, Fair, Slim, Good looking, Divorcee, Balija, highly Educated family, Well to do, requires suitable Bride-groom, Language No Barrier. Call: 982073428

CAVARA NAIDU age 30 Software Engineer Thiruvonam maharam D/B 37.1996 groom wanted Contact number: 9790548816

29YR NAIDU Divorcee Bride, MA, BEd, from an affluent, educated family seeks alliance Ph 6385293227

GIRL 32 fair 168cm we are looking for groom interested moving in our house only c9363714007 divorced no issues.

HINDU, GAVARA, Age 29/ 162, B.E Comp. girl seeks suitable groom from naidu/subcaste from Tamil Nadu.9443009611.

INVITING TELUGU Groom, 35y, Ht 160-cm, W: 9994032994 (industrialist parents only).

GAJULU BALIJA Naidu, Chennai, 26/ 158, fair, attractive seeks professional groom from good family. Ct:9600013579

NAidu Girl 30/185cm Aswini pursuing PhD Doctoral studies in Satellite Communications Neurobiology Computing European space agency Europe-completing by Dec 2026 seeking suitable Groom PhD / MS in USA. 9840103686

COSMOPOLITAN

Chettiar (shavadosham)/ cast no bar/ 34yrs/M.Tech, LLB/ Own business/5cr property Groom settle in Hyderabad req. girl any Degree. Ph: 6304162893.

DIVORCEE

DIVORCE 43, Hindu Govt Gazetted officer, seeks suitable educated bride caste no bar Ct: 63808 39406

IYER, 2ND Marriage, 44, B.E, Mirugaseeram, MNC Chennai, Suitable Vegetarian bride wanted. 7418006626

DOCTOR

Wanted Hindu Postgraduate completed Doctor Bride for Chennai based MS General Surgery Employed Doctor Contact 9381098707.

BRIDE WANTED
Leading Pediatrician from
Madurai running his own
Hospital, seeking Doctor
Bride for his Son who is also
a Pediatrician , 31 years,
175 cm, Fair, MD., DCH (Gold
Medalist - MMC Chennai),
hailing from Pillai
Community (Caste no bar)
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INBRIEF



Bhadrachalam temple redevelopment work begins

The much-awaited redevelopment works at the renowned Sree Seetha Ramachandra Swamy temple in the temple town of Bhadrachalam in Telangana commenced on Saturday, marking the start of the Phase-I works. In March this year, the State government accorded administrative sanction for ₹351 crore for the redevelopment and rejuvenation of the historic 17th-century temple in Bhadrachalam. A comprehensive master plan has been approved in three phases.

Five youth fined in Munnar for reckless driving; car seized

Five youth were spotted hanging out of the windows and the sunroof of a moving car along the Gap Road stretch of the Munnar-Bodimettu highway on Saturday. Upon noticing the dangerous behaviour, Munnar Dy.SP S. Chandrakumar intercepted the vehicle and had it moved to the Munnar police station. Mr. Chandrakumar stated that fine was imposed on the offenders and an awareness class will be conducted for them.

There are no grounds to book actor Tiny Tom: Kerala Police

The Kerala Police have decided not to register a case over a complaint filed by actor Ansiba Hassan against fellow actor Tiny Tom, accusing him of making communal and defamatory remarks against her. In a report submitted to the Assistant Commissioner of Police, Ernakulam Central, the station house officer of the Kadavanthra police station stated that the investigators could not find solid grounds to register a FIR after a preliminary investigation.

Tax rates on low-alcohol liquor to be included in Finance Bill

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

Amid the political row over lowering the sales tax on low-alcoholic beverages in Kerala, the revised tax rates have been included in the Finance (No. 3) Bill, 2026, which will be introduced in the Legislative Assembly on July 1. Section 3 of the Bill says the words 'low-alcoholic beverages' is to be inserted after 'horti-wine' in the Kerala General Sales Tax Act, 1963. The rates have been pegged at 120% and 175% respectively for alcoholic beverages with alcohol strength ranging from 0.5% v/v (volume by volume) to 10% v/v, and those with strength above 10% v/v and up to 20% v/v. These were the rates announced by Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan in the Revised Budget.

Gazette notification
At the same time, the specific amendment will not come into force immediately even if the Bill gets passed. The Bill notes that it will come into force when the government notifies it in the official gazette. The announcement had kicked up a major political storm with the Opposition Left Democratic Front (LDF) alleging that it promotes alcohol addiction. Mr. Satheesan had informed the Assembly on Wednesday that a final decision rests with the UDF. Mr. Satheesan had also pointed out that low-alcohol beverages as a new category was notified by the LDF government as part of its 2022-23 liquor policy.

SIT set to submit Sabarimala case report to HC tomorrow

Probe team questions key accused Unnikrishnan Potti again; it looks at board's decision to resend temple's gold-plated copper panels to a firm in Chennai, though they were refurbished in 2016

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

The Kerala High Court-appointed Special Investigation Team (SIT) probing the Sabarimala gold theft case has reportedly questioned Unnikrishnan Potti, the prime accused, again, ostensibly to tie up any possible loose ends concerning the previous Travancore Devaswom Board (TDB)'s decision to re-send the temple's gold-plated copper panels to Smart Creations, a metal works factory in Chennai, for electroplating in 2025.



Probe on: The SIT is probing whether fake defects were cited to send the panels at the Ayyappa temple for replating. LEJU KAMAL

The SIT is scheduled to submit its latest report in the case to the High Court on Monday. According to officials privy to the investigation, the SIT was reportedly

probing whether the previous TDB administration under the LDF government had cited non-existent defects to dispatch the gold-plated copper panels covering the Dwarapalaka

ED attack case: plea in HC to cancel bail

The Hindu Bureau
KOCHI

The Directorate of Enforcement (ED) has moved the Kerala High Court seeking the cancellation of bail granted to Harish Kumar, the ninth accused in the attack on Enforcement Directorate officials, during the raid on former Chief Minister of Kerala Pinarayi Vijayan's residence in May. The bail was granted by the Thiruvananthapuram Sessions Court on June 24. The ED expressed apprehension that the prosecutor of the Sessions

Court may have misinformed the court when the bail plea was considered, which resulted in the court granting him bail. The agency suspects that there could be other leaders who have called for the alleged attack, and they have not been investigated. A PIL is also pending before the High Court, seeking a probe by the Central Bureau of Investigation into the attack. The court has asked the State to file a statement regarding the steps taken after the FIR was registered for the offence.

Farmers block YSRCP leaders in Amaravati

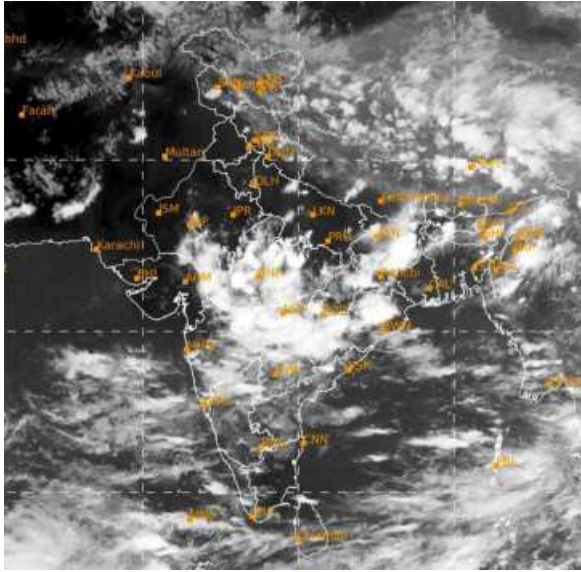
V. Raghavendra
VIJAYAWADA

Tension flared up in Amaravati, Andhra Pradesh, as a large number of farmers blocked the entry of YSR Congress Party (YSRCP) leaders, including Perni Venkataramaiah, Ambati Rambabu, Lella Appi Reddy and Devineni Avinash, into Undavalli, Penumaka and other villages on Saturday. The YSRCP leaders, under the banner of the CRDA Rythu Parirakshana Committee, wanted to visit the villages to highlight the

injustices allegedly meted out to the farmers who have parted with their land for the construction of Amaravati. Several farmers blocked the entry of the YSRCP leaders into their villages, strongly objecting to the latter's claim of fighting on their behalf. The farmers insisted that the YSRCP leaders had no right to visit Amaravati, accusing them of creating unrest for political gains. The situation became tense due to stone-pelting. They eventually left as the farmers refused to let them inspect the lands.

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday



TEMPERATURE DATA: IMD, POLLUTION DATA: AQICN/CPCB, MAP: INSAT/IMD (TAKEN AT 17.45 HRS)

Forecast for Sunday: Heavy/very heavy rainfall likely at isolated places over Arunachal Pradesh, Assam, Meghalaya, Manipur, Mizoram, Tripura, Sikkim, West Bengal, Bihar, Odisha, Telangana, Andhra Pradesh, Konkan & Goa, Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Puducherry, Karaikal, Kerala, Lakshadweep and Andaman & Nicobar Islands

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala		35.8	27.3	Kurnool		36.2	26.9
Ahmedabad		40.8	29.5	Lucknow		41.9	29.9
Aizawl		32.0	23.8	Madurai		38.6	24.8
Bengaluru		30.6	21.3	Mangaluru		31.7	23.0
Bhopal		36.3	24.8	Mumbai		33.4	25.9
Bhubaneswar		36.0	27.6	Mysuru		32.0	20.0
Chandigarh		40.2	27.4	New Delhi		41.3	30.8
Chennai		38.8	28.2	Patna		39.6	30.8
Coimbatore		24.4	22.8	Port Blair		16.3	30.0
Dehradun		23.4	26.3	Prayagraj		43.2	28.8
Gangtok		14.2	18.8	Puducherry		37.9	28.8
Goa		15.4	23.8	Pune		33.5	25.4
Guwahati		34.0	27.4	Raipur		38.9	26.6
Hubballi		30.0	23.0	Ranchi		32.5	24.1
Hyderabad		31.2	26.0	Shillong		0.1	17.0
Imphal		30.2	25.0	Shimla		12.6	16.2
Jaipur		39.8	29.4	Srinagar		0.4	33.0
Kochi		10.2	25.0	Thiruvananthapuram		10.4	31.0
Kohima		26.0	19.0	Tiruchirappalli		39.3	27.0
Kolkata		36.2	27.8	Vijayawada		22.5	33.0
Kozhikode		25.4	26.0	Visakhapatnam		31.4	28.5

(Rainfall data in mm; temperature in Celsius)								Yesterday	
Pollutants in the air you are breathing	SO ₂	NO ₂	CO	PM _{2.5}	PM ₁₀	CODE			
Ahmedabad		19		20		37		80	
Bengaluru		10		32		60		103	
Chennai		6		6		30		286	
Delhi		13		10		158		300	
Hyderabad		11		16		61		65	
Kolkata		9		20		25		77	
Lucknow		8		26		43		104	
Mumbai		7		11		56		31	
Pune		30		80		35		50	
Visakhapatnam		8		26		43		104	

Air Quality Code: Poor Moderate Good (Readings indicate average AQI)
SO₂: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.
NO₂: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.
CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.
PM_{2.5} & PM₁₀: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

Farm fresh



Tradition revived: A farmer uses a bullock-driven wooden 'ghani' to extract oil through traditional methods on his field on the outskirts of Warangal in Telangana. The age-old practice is seeing renewed interest as consumers seek healthier options. NAGARA GOPAL

Kerala HC seeks report on 'gold theft' from Ezharapponnana

The Hindu Bureau
KOCHI

The Kerala High Court has ordered the Chief Vigilance and Security Officer of the Travancore Devaswom Board (TDB) to inspect the temple registers as well as the Ezharapponnana of Ettumanur Mahadeva Temple and to submit a report with his opinion and findings on allegations pertaining to the gold plates on the elephant statuettes. The Ezharapponnana (which translates to seven-and-a-half golden elephants) consists of eight statuettes of elephants – seven of them two feet high and the eighth one, half the height. The officer



The Ezharapponnana idols at the Mahadeva temple, Ettumanur, Kottayam.

was also directed to use the services of a goldsmith so that the weight, quality, and originality of the gold are duly examined. The Division Bench of Justices Raja Vijayaraghavan and K.V. Jayakumar was consider-

ing the suo motu case based on a request by a devotee for an inquiry into the suspected misappropriation of gold on the Ezharapponnana and the alleged illegal occupation of temple properties. The complaint further said that during the repair works carried out on the gold plates covering the Ezharapponnana, the original plates were removed and replaced with copper or other low-value metals. The Administrative Officer and the Assistant Devaswom Commissioner had filed reports stating no records indicated any maintenance work or any misappropriation on the Ezharapponnana.

Telangana govt. launches e-autos to ease travel woes of persons with disabilities

The Hindu Bureau
HYDERABAD

The Telangana government on Saturday launched e-autos for 14 neighbourhood centres as part of its efforts to strengthen welfare services for persons with disabilities. Inaugurating the e-autos on the birth anniversary of Helen Keller, Minister for Panchayat Raj and Rural Development Dansari Anasuya, popularly known as Seethakka, said the newly launched e-autos would address transportation challenges faced by families and ensure free door-step transport for children requiring regular therapy and training, particularly



The government views persons with disabilities as equal partners in society, Seethakka said. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

those with autism and intellectual disabilities. Launching the service at Jyotirao Phule Praja Bhavan, she also announced that the government would further strengthen neighbourhood centres and establish new facilities where

rever necessary to ensure that disability-related services are available closer to people's homes. Stating that the government views persons with disabilities as equal partners in society rather than as recipients of charity, the

Minister said the Society for Elimination of Rural Poverty (SERP), which has been playing a key role in women's empowerment for over two decades, had also been entrusted with disability welfare initiatives. More than 13,000 Self-Help Groups (SHG) of persons with disabilities (PwD), with a membership exceeding 82,000, have been formed across the State under the aegis of SERP, she said. Ms. Seethakka said the Community Managed Rehabilitation Services programme was currently being implemented through 74 neighbourhood centres spread across 26 districts.

Global bids invited for Amaravati riverfront plan

Sambasiva Rao M.
AMARAVATI

The Amaravati Growth and Infrastructure Corporation Limited (AGICL) has invited global bids to appoint a consultant for preparing a comprehensive master plan, detailed project report (DPR) and financial plan for the proposed Amaravati Riverfront Development Project along the Krishna River, with implementation support for a pilot project targeted for completion before Krishna Pushkaralu-2028. According to the Request for Proposal (RFP), the project is a part of the Andhra Pradesh government's vision to develop Amaravati into a world-class, sustainable and future-ready capital city.



A satellite map showing the location of the proposed Amaravati Riverfront pilot project. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

The proposed project covers nearly 27 km of the Krishna River, extending from Undavalli in the east to Vyikuntapuram in the west, including seven river islands spread over about 20 square kilometres. As the first phase, a priority pilot project has been identified at Uddandirayunipalem. The selected consultant

will prepare the master plan, engineering designs, landscape concepts, environmental management strategies and implementation roadmap. The consultant will also assist AGICL in obtaining statutory approvals, preparing tender documents, supporting bid management and supervising implementation of the pilot project.

From Page One

Ram Temple row: Trust general secretary quits

However, the war of words over the episode intensified on Saturday, with the Samajwadi Party (SP) president Akhilesh Yadav vowing to “restore and nurture the eternal glory of Ayodhya as a centre of faith and devotion”.

He claimed that a new SP-led Uttar Pradesh government will develop ‘Ayodhya’ as a unique and exemplary religious city, where devotees will experience true spirituality.

Congress leaders continued to demand the arrest of Mr. Rai and alleged that the government was shielding him.

“Champat Rai is a small fish of the whole nexus, the real thieves are sitting in Delhi. The whole BJP-RSS ecosystem stole money from common devotees and used it to generate hate in society against marginalised sections,” senior U.P. Congress leader Anil Yadav said.

It was on June 25 that the Ayodhya police registered a first information report (FIR) in the case, on the basis of a petition from the Trust. Eight accused were booked on charges of embezzlement, criminal conspiracy, fraud and breach of Trust under sections 305, 306, 317, 317 (5), 61 and 3(5) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS).

All the eight - Avinash Shukla, Anukalp Mishra, Luvkush Mishra, Manish Kumar Yadav, Karunesh Pandey Rama Shankar Mishra, Subhash Srivastava, Rama Shankar Yadav alias Tinnu - were arrested the same day and sent to judicial custody for three days till June 29.

Maharashtra TET put off over ‘paper leak’

“Officials of the Maharashtra State Examination Council [MSEC] were immediately called to the spot. They verified the seized papers. During the investigation, it was observed that some of the questions found with the suspects and the questions in the TET paper were the same,” the government statement said.

“The process of organising an examination of this scale typically takes around three weeks. Candidates who had already registered for the examination will not have to register again. Since the candidates are not at fault, no re-registration fee will be charged,” MSEC Deputy Commissioner Priya Shinde said. A first information report (FIR) has been registered against three persons, she said, adding that strict action will be taken against those found responsible.

The new date for the examination and other related information will be published on the official website of the MSEC.

The Chief Minister constituted a Special Investigation Team under Thane Joint CP Panjabrao Ugale to probe the paper leak. He also directed School Education Minister Dada Bhuse and DGP Sadanand Date to take strict action against the culprits. Deputy Chief Minister Eknath Shinde said the accused should be booked under the stringent Maharashtra Control of Organised Crime Act (MCOCA).

Screenplay maestro and hero takes his last bow

Bhagyaraj began working in the Tamil film industry in the mid-1970s as an assistant director under his guide and mentor Bharathiraja, working in iconic films such as *16 Vayathinilale*, *Kizhakke Pogum Rail*, and *Sigappu Rojakkal*. He developed his skills as a dialogue and screenplay writer.

His debut as a hero was in the movie *Pudhiya Vaarpugal*, co-starring Rati Agnihotri, and his directorial debut was with the film *Suvarillatha Chithirangal*.

In 1981, he married co-star Praveena, but she died in 1983. The next year, Bhagyaraj married Poornima, his co-star from the movie *Darling, Darling, Darling*.

Hindi remakes

Bhagyaraj has directed a total of 27 feature films across the Tamil and Hindi languages. When the hit Tamil film *Oru Kaidhiyin Diary* (1985) – originally directed by Bharathiraja and starring Kamal Haasan – was remade in Hindi as *Aakhree Raasta* (1986), Bhagyaraj was roped in as the director. For the Hindi version, Bollywood icon Amitabh Bachchan stepped into the shoes of the lead.

Following this success, Bhagyaraj went on to direct *Mr. Bechara* (1996), the Hindi remake of his 1998 Tamil film *Vettiya Madichu Kattu*, starring Krishan Kumar and Nagma. However, this particular venture failed to make a mark at the box office.

In the subsequent phase of his directorial career, the only film that stood out as noteworthy was *Chokka Thangam*. Beyond his work behind the camera, Bhagyaraj has had a prolific acting career, appearing in over 80 films across Tamil and other regional languages, in lead, supporting, and cameo roles. Demonstrating his true versatility, he also composed the music for five films.

His corneas were donated to an eyebank in Chennai. (With inputs from K. Muralidharan and Ramya Kannan)

Modi hands over ‘Made in India’ vessel to Seychelles

Press Trust of India
VICTORIA

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Saturday handed over a ‘Made in India’ Fast Patrol Vessel to the Seychelles Coast Guard, reaffirming New Delhi’s commitment to strengthening the archipelago nation’s maritime capabilities.

Mr. Modi and Seychelles President Patrick Herminie participated in the handover ceremony at the Coast Guard Base in Victoria, Seychelles, during Mr. Modi’s three-day visit to the Indian Ocean archipelago.

The Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) said the vessel, *PS LESPWAR*, will strengthen Seychelles’ maritime surveillance and Exclusive Economic Zone (EEZ) patrol capabilities.

The MEA said Mr. Modi also handed over six ambulances, 10 utility vehicles and five laser radial boats.

“Together as partners. Stronger as one,” the MEA said in a post on X, adding that the two countries continue to deepen their defence partnership under India’s Vision MAHASAGAR (Mutual and Holistic Advancement for Security and Growth Across Regions).

SIR enumeration in Delhi and four States to begin on June 30

There are about 19.79 crore voters in Karnataka, Meghalaya, Maharashtra, Jharkhand, and Delhi; final electoral lists post the SIR will be out on Oct. 7

Sreeparna Chakrabarty
NEW DELHI

The enumeration phase for the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls in Karnataka, Meghalaya, Maharashtra, Jharkhand, and Delhi is set to begin from June 30.

There is a total of 19,78,94,740 voters in these four States and Delhi as of May 12. The final voter lists for these States post the SIR process will be published on October 7.

The ongoing third phase of the SIR is being conducted in 16 States and three Union Territories. Over 3.94 lakh Booth Level Officers (BLOs) will go house to house to verify 36.73 crore electors, assisted by 3.42 lakh Booth Level Agents (BLAs) appointed by political parties in this phase.

Pruning the rolls

With this phase, the exercise will cover the entire country except Himachal



Door-to-door: In the ongoing third phase of the SIR, over 3.94 lakh Booth Level Officers will verify 36.73 crore electors. G. RAMAKRISHNA

Pradesh, Jammu and Kashmir, and Ladakh. The SIR schedule for these will be announced later after considering the completion of Phase-II of the Census and due consideration of the weather in the upper reaches or snow bound areas, the Election Commission of India (EC) said.

When the second phase of the SIR was announced for 12 States/UTs by the EC on October 27, 2025, their cumulative voter base stood at more than 50.99 crore. It now stands at

45.81 crore post the SIR, a decline of over 5.18 crore or a 10.2% cut in the electoral rolls of these States and UTs.

With a number of those States going to the polls in subsequent months, the SIR exercise triggered acrimony between the Opposition and the poll body, and has been challenged in courts as well.

In March, however, the Supreme Court unanimously upheld the constitutional validity of the EC’s move to carry out the SIR.

Parliament was misled by govt. on casualties during Operation Sindoor: Cong.

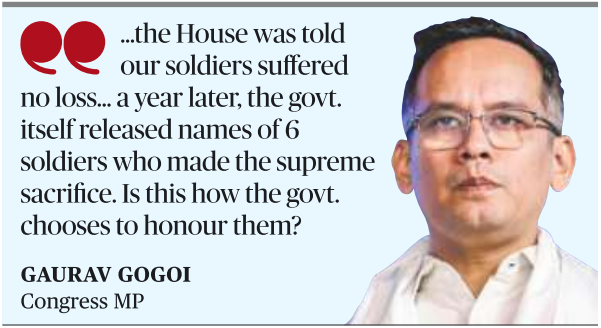
The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

A day after the government officially released the names of the soldiers who died during Operation Sindoor, the Congress on Saturday accused Union Defence Minister Rajnath Singh of misleading Parliament by stating that no Indian soldier had died during the military operation.

The government’s disclosure had exposed a contradiction between the Defence Minister’s statement in Parliament and the official record, the party said, demanding the Centre place the complete facts relating to the operation before the House during the forthcoming monsoon session.

The Congress’s deputy leader in the Lok Sabha Gaurav Gogoi said that during the parliamentary debate on Operation Sindoor, he had urged the Defence Minister to present “the complete truth” before the Parliament and the nation.

“Instead, the House was unequivocally told that our soldiers had suffered no loss,” he said in a post on X. A year later, the government itself had officially released the names of six personnel who had made



...the House was told our soldiers suffered no loss... a year later, the govt. itself released names of 6 soldiers who made the supreme sacrifice. Is this how the govt. chooses to honour them?

GAURAV GOGOI
Congress MP

“the supreme sacrifice” during the operation, Mr. Gogoi added.

‘Stark contradiction’

“The government’s own admission exposes a stark contradiction. Parliament was misled on a matter of the highest national importance. The families of our martyrs deserve the truth. Our brave soldiers deserve to have their sacrifice acknowledged with honesty and dignity. Is this how the government chooses to honour those who gave their lives in service of the nation?” he said.

Congress general secretary Randeep Singh Surjewala also attacked the Centre, alleging that it had failed to speak the truth even on the issue of soldiers’ sacrifices. “The age of a lie is short, the truth of martyrdom is indelible. Those who do not speak

the truth even for martyrdom, what respect will they show to the martyrs! Those who shamelessly lie in the temple of democracy, who will believe them!” Mr. Surjewala said on X. Casualties were an inevitable possibility in military operations, senior Congress leader and Chandigarh MP Manish Tewari said, questioning why the government had sought to conceal the facts.

“In a kinetic action casualties do happen. Why obfuscate the facts and dissimulate, and that too to Parliament – the supreme legislative institution of the nation?” he said.

“If there are some other facts pertaining to Operation Sindoor, government should squarely put them on the table of Parliament during the ensuing monsoon session without demur,” Mr. Tewari said.

Defence Minister’s remarks being taken out of context: govt.

Saurabh Trivedi
NEW DELHI

The Union government on Saturday rejected the “misleading social media claims” that Defence Minister Rajnath Singh had stated that no Indian soldier was killed during Operation Sindoor, asserting that his remarks in Parliament had been selectively quoted and stripped of their context.

On July 28, 2025, while speaking before the Lok Sabha, Rajnath Singh stated that no Indian soldiers were harmed during Operation Sindoor. While speaking for 55 minutes during the 16-hour-long discussion, he said, “If you want to raise a question, then ask whether any of our brave soldiers were harmed in this operation. The answer is, no, none of our soldiers were harmed.”

“When the objectives are high then our attention should not be on irrelevant issues. Because by focusing on irrelevant issues at times, our attention gets diverted from important issues related to national security and morale of soldiers,” he had said.

‘Misrepresented words’

The Ministry of Defence (MoD) clarified in a statement that certain social

NIA chargesheets 3 more accused in Red Fort blast case

Devesh K. Pandey
NEW DELHI

The National Investigation Agency (NIA) has chargesheeted three more accused, including an absconder, in connection with the November 2025 car bomb explosion near the Red Fort.

In its supplementary charge sheet, the NIA has named Zameer Ahmad Ahanger, Tufail Ahmad Bhat, and Muzafar Ahmad alias Faraz/Zafar, all from Jammu and Kashmir, as accused. This takes the number of persons chargesheeted to 13, including the prime accused, Umer Un Nabi, who died in the blast.

“Absconding accused Muzafar Ahmed, a paediatrician (MBBS, MD), has been identified as the elder brother of co-accused Dr. Adeel Ahmed Rather and a founding member of Ansar Ghazwat-ul-Hind (AGuH) – an offshoot of al-Qaeda in the Indian Subcontinent (AQIS),” the agency said.

According to the NIA, Mr. Muzafar could be one of the prime architects, along with co-accused Umer, Muzammil, Adeel, and Mufti Irfan, of the conspiracy that led to the vehicle-

With this, 13 persons, including the prime accused who died in the blast, have been chargesheeted

borne improvised explosive device (IED) blast on November 10, 2025.

“One of the founding members of AGuH Interim, Mr. Muzafar, had attended the secret Eidgah meeting at Srinagar in June 2022, during which the terror module AGuH Interim was established,” it said.

The agency alleged that Mr. Muzafar was deeply involved in the manufacture, testing and safekeeping of TATP (triacetone triperoxide)-based IEDs at a clandestine facility run by Umer and Muzammil at Al-Falah University in Haryana’s Faridabad. A non-bailable warrant has been issued against him.

As per the NIA, Mr. Zameer is an Overground Worker (OGW) of AGuH Interim. “Tufail, a former OGW of the proscribed Lashkar-e-Taiba terror organisation, had procured ammunition and delivered them to the main accused Dr. Umer Un Nabi,” it said.

Despite dip in global fuel prices, Centre is denying relief: Kharage

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Congress president Mallikarjun Kharage on Saturday accused the Narendra Modi government of refusing to pass on the benefit of falling global crude oil prices to consumers, alleging that the Centre was treating the public as a source of tax revenue rather than providing relief.

In a post on X, Mr. Kharage said international crude oil prices had fallen to pre-West Asia war levels, but petrol, diesel and LPG prices remained high.

Describing it as the BJP’s “habit of looting and pick-pocketing”, he alleged that while crude oil prices had tumbled, the government had continued to “tighten the reins” on household savings instead of reducing fuel prices.

Posing a series of questions to the Centre, Mr. Kharage said that when the conflict in West Asia had pushed crude oil prices to about \$138 a barrel, petrol was selling at a retail price of ₹94.77 a litre and diesel at ₹87.67 a litre. With crude oil now down to about \$70.71 a barrel, petrol was still being sold at ₹102.12 a litre and diesel at ₹95.20 a litre, he said.

Plea in SC seeks fire safety protocol for high-risk buildings

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

A petition has been filed in the Supreme Court seeking the creation of a National Minimum Fire and Life Safety Framework for high-risk public occupancy premises, including schools, coaching centres, hotels, hospitals, and commercial complexes.

The petition, filed by advocate Narendra Kumar Goswami, comes in the wake of two devastating fire incidents in June – the Malviya Nagar guest house

fire in Delhi and the Aliganj coaching centre fire in Lucknow, which together resulted in at least 37 deaths.

Mr. Goswami has argued that the recurring pattern of preventable fire fatalities constitutes a systemic constitutional failure.

“The right to life under Article 21 is not a right to be rescued after the fire; it is a right not to be knowingly exposed to preventable fire-death by a regulatory State that has the power, the codes, and the duty to



Rescue operations under way at the building where a massive fire erupted in Aliganj, Lucknow, a few days ago. ANI

prevent such danger,” the petition said.

The plea sought direc-

tions from the court to the government to introduce a system of time-bound fire

and electrical safety audits for high-risk public premises; create a centralised, public digital portal displaying valid Fire NOCs, occupancy certificates, and audit compliance status; prohibit the use of basements, rooftops, and temporary structures for classrooms, coaching, or public assembly without explicit safety approval; introduce tamper-proof, QR-coded fire safety certificates carrying severe penal consequences for false certification; constitute District Fire and Life Safety

Enforcement Committees headed by District Magistrates; and establish a strict liability compensation protocol for victims of fires occurring in non-compliant premises.

The plea said isolated FIRs and post-facto inquiry committees were constitutionally insufficient.

The petitioner has also asked the Supreme Court to retain a “continuing mandamus” of the fire safety issue until the first national audit cycle and public disclosure portal are fully operational.

INBRIEF



Vigil stepped up over security threat to Delhi, Uttarakhand

Intelligence agencies have issued a security alert for Delhi and Uttarakhand following a possible Khalistani terror threat, with key religious sites, government establishments and police installations put under heightened surveillance, sources said on Saturday. According to sources, the alert was triggered after an email surfaced warning of possible attacks in the coming days. This threat comes in the backdrop of a standoff at the Nagrasu gurdwara in Uttarakhand's Rudraprayag district between a group of Nihangs and the authorities. Sources said the Delhi Police have launched a probe into the email to ascertain its authenticity and trace its origin. PTI

Civilian dies in explosion near LoC in Jammu and Kashmir

A civilian was killed in an explosion near the Line of Control (LoC) in the Gulmarg area of north Kashmir's Baramulla district on Saturday, officials said. Officials identified the victim as Zabir Ahmad Bajat, son of Mohammad Rafiq Bajat, a resident of Baramulla district. Initial official assessment suggested that the civilian died after an unexploded shell went off. However, the Army and the police could not provide details about the exact circumstances leading to the blast. The unexploded shell was apparently lying close to the Asha Post near the LoC in Gulmarg.

Second body recovered after floods in Arunachal Pradesh

Rescue teams on Saturday recovered the body of one of the four persons missing after a cloudburst and resultant flash floods hit a hydropower project colony in Arunachal Pradesh's Keyi Panyor district on June 24. The district's SP, Angad Mehta, said locals identified the victim as 30-year-old Ballari Marak, hailing from Meghalaya's Ri-Bhoi district. Hers was the second body recovered after that of Nirmala Gupta, 35, a teacher at NEEPCO's Vivekananda Kendriya Vidyalaya, on the day of the disaster. "The State Disaster Response Force and Keyi Panyor police personnel are continuing the search and rescue operations for three other missing persons, despite adverse conditions," Mr. Mehta said.

Assam police arrest 2 ULFA(I) members, avert 'terror strike'

The Assam police claimed it averted a major terror strike by apprehending two members of the banned United Liberation of Asom (Independent) in Tinsukia district on Friday. They were identified as "second lieutenant" Humenjyoti Baruah (27), and Papu Moran (30). Tinsukia's Superintendent of Police, Mayank Kumar, said the duo was caught with the help of central agencies near Arunachal Pradesh border. Two AK-56 assault rifles, two hand grenades, 172 rounds of AK ammunition, opioids, and jungle survival kits were recovered from them. "The ULFA(I) had tasked them to target and kill people in Tinsukia town to create terror," he said.

SUDOKU

			7	4		1		
1	3					9		
		5				8		6
	1		3					
	2	3		5		6	4	
					2		9	
7		6				2		
		1					6	5
	9		6		5			

DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★★★★★

Solution to yesterday's Sudoku

5	1	8	7	4	3	6	9	2
3	2	4	6	1	9	8	7	5
7	9	6	8	2	5	3	1	4
4	7	9	5	3	6	2	8	1
6	5	1	2	7	8	4	3	9
2	8	3	4	9	1	7	5	6
1	3	2	9	6	7	5	4	8
9	6	5	3	8	4	1	2	7
8	4	7	1	5	2	9	6	3

How saving elephants helps forests breathe easier

Rahul Karmakar
GUWAHATI

Protecting the endangered Asiatic elephant (*Elephas maximus indicus*) indirectly helps safeguard India's forests as powerful carbon stores, a new scientific study has said.

The research, however, warned that long-term carbon stabilisation cannot be ensured merely by declaring more areas as elephant reserves but by improving habitat quality, restoring wildlife corridors, and strengthening forest management. Carbon stabilisation, a vital mechanism for removing greenhouse gases and mitigating climate change, is the process of trapping atmospheric carbon and locking it into stable, solid forms (such as in soil or organic matter). This helps resist decay, erosion, or the release of carbon back into the atmosphere.

The study, published in the latest issue of the *Journal of Threatened Taxa*, assessed the relationship between elephant conservation efforts, the expansion of elephant reserves, and wildlife-associated carbon stock enhancement in India from 1992 to 2025. Noida-based Amity University's Tarun Kathula and Tanu Jindal are its authors.

The researchers found that India's elephant reserve network expanded from 18,297 sq. km. (across three elephant reserves) to 80,777 sq. km. (33 elephant reserves), while the elephant population increased by about 6.7% from 25,604 estimated during 1992-93. Despite the marginal increase in the number of pachyderms, the estimated carbon stored within the elephant reserves increased by 38%. The increase should not be interpreted as the ele-



Elephants remain ecologically vital, despite their limited contribution to faunal biomass, the researchers said. THULASI KAKKAT

phants directly creating more forest biomass, the researchers said, as it "primarily reflects enhanced protection and reduced degradation of pre-existing forest carbon stocks."

The study estimated that about 95% of the increase in carbon storage resulted from the expansion of protected forest areas. However, elephant reserves are not uniformly conserved in the same

manner as legally designated national parks or tiger reserves.

Ecosystem engineers Elephants, often described as ecosystem engineers, remain ecologically vital, despite their limited contribution to faunal biomass, the researchers said. The gentle giants, they pointed out, disperse seeds, enrich soils with dung, create space for di-

verse vegetation, and help maintain healthy forests capable of storing carbon over the long term.

The researchers also found a weak relationship between the number of elephant reserves and the elephant population growth, suggesting that administrative declarations alone cannot secure the species' future if habitats remain fragmented or poorly managed.

Declining numbers The study further underlined a worrying trend – the decline in elephant numbers under a new census methodology called Synchronised All-India Elephant Estimate (SAIEE) 2021-25, while the number of elephant reserves has stabilised. The SAIEE count of 22,446 was 4,065 elephants fewer than the 2017 estimate, but the enumerators asserted that the two different counting

methods should not be compared.

Comparable patterns were observed in the African savannah ecosystems, where mega-herbivore management improved vegetation carbon stocks by 20-30%. "Such consistency across regions supports the ecological principle that mega-fauna protection complements forest-carbon goals," their study said. "Policy integration of these results can strengthen India's commitments to achieve 2.5-3 billion tCO₂ (total carbon dioxide) equivalent additional carbon sink by 2030. Incorporating wildlife-inclusive accounting within REDD+ frameworks could generate measurable ecosystem-service credits while ensuring co-benefits for biodiversity," the study said. REDD expands to 'Reducing Emissions from Deforestation and Forest Degradation'.

U.S. names Indian firm, CEO in Sudan sanctions

Press Trust of India
WASHINGTON

The U.S. imposed sanctions on eight persons and entities, including an Indian national associated with an explosives manufacturing firm, for allegedly fuelling the civil war in Sudan.

The U.S. Treasury Department's Office of Foreign Assets Control (OFAC) on Friday said the targeted networks enabled both the Sudanese Armed Forces (SAF) and the Rapid Support Forces (RSF) to expand and intensify civil war in the African nation and created the "world's worst humanitarian crisis and provided space for terrorist groups to operate".

Among the sanctioned individuals is Alok Choudhari of Raipur, the Chief Executive Officer of SBL Energy Limited, also known as Amin Explosive Private Limited, which allegedly supplied over 200 shipments of explosives and materials to a company that maintained the SAF's arsenal.

The Treasury Department also imposed sanctions on Raipur-based SBL Energy Limited.

Shah attacks cab aggregators over 'unfair' business model

Union Minister says newly launched cooperative ride-hailing platform Bharat Taxi is an alternative that will safeguard interests of drivers, passengers; it will expand to over 500 cities within 2 years

Abhinav Deshpande
AHMEDABAD

Union Cooperation Minister Amit Shah on Saturday launched a sharp attack on private app-based cab aggregators such as Uber and Ola, alleging that their business model exploits both drivers and commuters through practices that prioritise corporate profits over fair treatment. He said the newly launched cooperative ride-hailing platform, Bharat Taxi, was conceived to provide an alternative that safeguards the interests of drivers while ensuring better service for passengers.

Addressing the launch of Bharat Taxi in 14 cities across Gujarat, Mr. Shah, without naming the companies, alleged that private platforms deduct hefty commissions from drivers, delay payments and suspend their registrations based solely on passenger complaints without giving them an opportunity to present their case.

He said the cooperative



Union Home Minister Amit Shah takes a taxi ride during the launch of 'Bharat Taxi' in Gujarat. PTI

model was introduced to eliminate such practices and ensure that drivers are treated as stakeholders rather than service providers dependent on private companies.

Competitors' challenge "I received phone calls today and some newspapers have reported that Bharat Taxi's fares are higher. I want to tell customers across the country that wherever Bharat Taxi begins operations, competing companies immediately slash their fares and are

prepared to incur losses. Our intention is not to inflict losses on anyone, but reducing fares and offering higher commissions to *sarathis* (drivers) is being done only to prevent Bharat Taxi from entering the market," he said.

"They want Bharat Taxi to fail so they can once again function arbitrarily," he said, adding that such strategies would not succeed in India, where "the spirit of cooperation and the desire to work for the welfare of others are the greatest strength".

Bharat Taxi, which was soft-launched in Gujarat last December, is being projected as India's first cooperative-owned, driver-led ride-hailing platform. Operating on a zero-commission model, it allows drivers to retain the entire fare while also giving them ownership in the platform.

The platform was formally launched in Ahmedabad, Surat, Vadodara, Rajkot, Dwarka, among other cities across Gujarat. It will initially offer services in three categories – two-wheelers, auto-rickshaws and four-wheelers.

Mr. Shah said Bharat Taxi would begin operations in Nagpur, Pune, Mumbai, Lucknow, Chandigarh, Jaipur and Kolkata before July 31, and services would be extended to more than 500 cities and towns over the next two years.

Addressing the drivers, he said they had become part of the country's larger cooperative movement, which already includes crores of farmers.

It is theft of youth's future: Rahul on TET 'paper leak'

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

Congress leader Rahul Gandhi on Saturday described the alleged paper leak and postponement of the Maharashtra Teacher Eligibility Test (TET) as "theft" of the future of youngsters.

"Another paper leak. Another exam cancelled. This time, Maharashtra's TET," he said.

"The country's education and examination system has been turned into a system of extortion, leaving every youngster in the country insecure," the leader of opposition in the Lok Sabha said in a post in Hindi on X.

Congress leader Priyanka Gandhi Vadra also voiced concern over the matter.

In a post on X, she said, "Youth, wake up!!! Until you raise your voice loud and clear, this terror with your future will continue unabated. You've been deceived once again."

Congress leader Pawan Khera slammed the government over the development, claiming that it seems determined to score a "shameful century".

Govt. to launch affordable digital management system for clinics

Bindu Shajan Perappadan
NEW DELHI

Aimed at helping small outpatient clinics that face challenges with manual processes and lack of affordable digital solutions, the Union Health Ministry is all set to launch the e-Sushrut@Clinic.

eSushrut@Clinic is a light Hospital Management Information System (HMIS), created by Centre for Development of Advanced Computing (C-DAC) to address these challenges by providing a simple, affordable, and user-friendly digital solution specifically tailored for small outpatient clinics.

"Large HMIS are often too complex and costly for these clinics and this results in small clinics struggling with inefficiencies in digitisation of the health system," said a release issued by the Ministry.

It added that the need of having a government-backed and affordable

Ministry proposes to open light HMIS for govt. primary health centres, sub-centres and private clinics

HMIS has been coming from various microsite participants in spite of a large number of private HMIS players. Many States/Union Territories have also expressed interest to use a light HMIS for their public facilities.

The Ministry proposes to open the light HMIS for government primary health centres, sub-centres and private clinics, etc.

C-DAC implementing it Currently, over 800 health facilities are onboarded on eSushrut@Clinic, generating over 680 health records. C-DAC is also implementing the eSushrut software, which is being installed at more than 15 AI-IMS and in various State government hospitals.

Listing the features, the Ministry said that e-Sushrut@Clinic provides a lightweight, cloud-based HMIS designed specifically for outpatient clinics which simplifies tasks like patient registration, billing, etc., thus making work easier and reducing mistakes. C-DAC will take care of maintenance and upgradation of the software.

"It is designed to be simple and intuitive, with no technical expertise needed from clinic staff. Also, this simple platform can be accessed from any device, without needing complex setups," said the release.

The cost of eSushrut@clinic is estimated to be ₹499 per month for five users. A discount of ₹200 will be given making the effective rate to be ₹299 per month. The software will be offered at no cost for the initial three months. Each additional user beyond the included five-user limit will be charged at a rate of ₹50 per user.

CGHS enhances financial powers of officials to expedite treatment

Bindu Shajan Perappadan
NEW DELHI

In a move aimed at reducing delays in medical treatment and reimbursement under the Central Government Health Scheme (CGHS), the Union Health Ministry has now substantially enhanced the financial powers of senior CGHS officials to approve cashless treatment, settle medical reimbursement claims and sanction unlisted investigations and procedures.

The revised delegation of powers enables additional directors heading CGHS cities and zones, as well as senior officials at the CGHS headquarters, to approve significantly higher-value cases than before. The changes are expected to reduce the number of proposals that require referral to higher authorities, speeding up decisions on treatment approvals and claim settlements.

Under the revised dele-

Changes expected to benefit pensioners, elderly – accounting for a substantial share of CGHS users

gation, additional directors heading CGHS cities and zones can now sanction medical reimbursement claims and hospital bills at approved rates – of up to ₹15 lakh, compared with the earlier limit of ₹7 lakh, for directors the revised power stands at ₹25 lakh from ₹15 lakh, and for Additional Secretary and DG, CGHS has revised financial approval power of ₹50 lakh, up from ₹25 lakh.

Cases exceeding ₹50 lakh shall continue to be referred to the Union Health Ministry for approval with the concurrence of the Integrated Finance Division.

For unlisted investigations/procedures and implants, additional directors heading CGHS cities and

zones, director, and additional secretary and DG, have revised approval powers up to ₹2 lakh, ₹5 lakh and ₹10 lakh respectively.

The order, dated June 25, now raises the financial limits for settling medical reimbursement claims submitted by beneficiaries after treatment. Such claims, particularly those involving high-cost procedures or emergency care, have often required multiple levels of scrutiny before reimbursement could be sanctioned.

Speaking about the revision, a senior health official said the changes are expected to particularly benefit pensioners and elderly beneficiaries, who account for a substantial share of CGHS users and often require costly tertiary care.

Delays in administrative approvals and reimbursement of medical expenses have remained among the most common grievances of beneficiaries.

Why is Delhi's EV policy 2.0 facing opposition?

Which document proves Indian citizenship?

What do the amended FCRA Rules say?

CM
YK

INBRIEF



Mercedes driver Russell grabs pole for the Austrian GP

George Russell produced a dramatic late and contentious fastest lap in his Mercedes on Saturday to claim pole position ahead of the two Ferraris for Sunday's Austrian GP in Spielberg.

The starting grid: First row: George Russell (Mercedes), Charles Leclerc (Ferrari); **Second:** Lewis Hamilton (Ferrari), Kimi Antonelli (Mercedes); **Third:** Max Verstappen (Red Bull), Lando Norris (McLaren); **Fourth:** Oscar Piastri (McLaren), Isack Hadjar (Red Bull); **Fifth:** Liam Lawson (Racing Bulls), Arvid Lindblad (Racing Bulls); **Sixth:** Pierre Gasly (Alpine), Gabriel Bortoleto (Audi); **Seventh:** Oliver Bearman (Haas), Nico Hulkenberg (Audi); **Eighth:** Estabén Ocon (Haas), Franco Colapinto (Alpine); **Ninth:** Carlos Sainz (Williams), Alexander Albon (Williams); **Tenth:** Sergio Perez (Cadillac), Valtteri Bottas (Cadillac); **11th:** Fernando Alonso (Aston Martin), Lance Stroll (Aston Martin).

Nabi's four-wicket burst puts India-A in the driver's seat

Pacer Auqib Nabi's four-wicket burst put India-A in the driver's seat with an overall lead of 170 runs against Sri Lanka-A on the third day of the first 'Test' in Galle on Saturday. Starting the day at 113 for two, SL-A was in control at 300 for five until Nabi bowled a fiery spell to bundle out the host for 330. In India-A's second innings, Ayush Pandey and Devdutt Padikkal were unbeaten at close after Sai Sudharsan had to retire hurt.

The scores: India-A 452/6 decl & 48/0 in 17 overs vs. Sri Lanka-A 330 in 101.4 overs (Fernando 84, Bandara 70, Arachchige 72, Nabi 4/58).

Indonesia pips India, makes AVC Cup title decider

Indonesia halted India's five-match winning streak in the AVC Men's Volleyball Cup as it emerged victorious 15-25, 26-24, 25-20, 19-25, 15-13 in the semifinal in Ahmedabad on Saturday.

Devika, Rounak and Srikanth enter U.S. Open semifinals

Devika Sihag upset third seed Riko Gunji of Japan, while Rounak Chouhan reached the semifinals of U.S. Open badminton tournament at Fullerton. K. Srikanth packed off Liao Jhuo-Fu of Taiwan 21-9, 12-21, 21-8 in the other quarterfinal.

The results (quarterfinals): Women: Devika Sihag bt Riko Gunji 22-20, 21-19; Line Christophersen bt Tanvi Sharma 21-16, 11-21, 21-11; Rachel Chan bt Rakshitha Sree 15-21, 21-16, 21-12. **Men:** Rounak Chouhan bt Misha Zilberman 23-21, 21-11; K. Srikanth bt Liao Jhuo-Fu 21-9, 12-21, 21-8.

Jr Indian shuttlers enter the Asian mixed team quarters

India sealed a spot in the quarterfinals of the Badminton Asia junior mixed team championships with a 2-0 (55-31, 55-21) victory over Kazakhstan in its Group-C opener in Yatsushiro, Japan, on Saturday.

Jangoo and Chase keep WI in the hunt for lead

Amir Jangoo (78 batting) and captain Roston Chase (42 batting) took the West Indies within reach of Sri Lanka's first innings total as the home side closed day two of the first Test in North Sound at 271 for five.

The scores: Sri Lanka 308 in 71.5 overs vs West Indies 271/5 in 84 overs (Jangoo 78 batting, Chase 42 batting).

INTER-DIST. CRICKET

Vaishnavi fires Salem to big win
SALEM: S. Vaishnavi top-scored with an unbeaten 119 (131b, 14x4) as Salem beat Krishnagiri by eight wickets in the TNCA inter-district women's tournament semifinals on Saturday.
Salem will take on Tiruvallur in the final.
The scores (semifinals): Krishnagiri 250/4 in 50 overs (K. Hashini 48, M. Sudheshna 49, U. Chathuraya 63, M. Thejes Sree 59 n.o.)

lost to Salem 253/2 in 47.4 overs (R. Abarna 32, S. Vaishnavi 119 n.o., K. Akshayamathi 52 n.o.).
At Coimbatore: Coimbatore 133 in 46.5 overs (S. Sweata 37, D. Swagata 3/21) lost to Tiruvallur 105/7 in 30.2 overs (B. Shree Swagatha 3/34) (Tiruvallur won by three wickets by VJD Method after rain interruption; revised target 105 in 31 overs).

India eyes improved batting show in its bid to level series

After coming a cropper in the opening match, Shreyas' men will hope to sign off the short tour on a winning note; the host is a step away from scripting another piece of history

INDIA IN IRELAND

Press Trust of India
BELFAST

India's star-studded batting line-up will be under pressure to make amends when it takes on a buoyant Ireland in the second and final T20I here on Sunday.
After a shock defeat in the opener, Shreyas Iyer's men need a win to level the series. Playing its first match since the T20 World Cup triumph in March, India was handed one of its biggest upsets as Ireland registered its maiden victory over the Men in Blue in any format.
With the five-game series against England beginning on Wednesday at Chester-le-Street, Shreyas will be eager to sign off the short Ireland tour on a winning note.
The biggest concern from the opening game was India's batting collapse. Sanju Samson lasted

just four balls before becoming debutant Jai Moon-dra's maiden international wicket while Ishan Kishan and Shreyas, too, fell for single-digit scores inside the PowerPlay.
Abhishek Sharma carried on in his explosive manner but lacked support from the other end.
The team management, however, is unlikely to press the panic button after one just defeat.
Even as the batting unit disappointed in the first match, the bowling pack offered positives.
Harshit Rana made an impressive comeback after a four-month layoff due to a knee injury, using his variations smartly to return figures of three for 24.
Left-arm pacer Arshdeep Singh and left-arm spinner Axar Patel also bowled well. As for the Lorcán Tucker-led Ireland, it will be brimming with confidence after having scripted history on Friday.
Match starts at 6 p.m. IST.



Pace threat: Hollard, who had posed a tough challenge to the Indian batters on Friday, will look to impress again. GETTY IMAGES

AFI confirms Neeraj's participation in Asian Games

Press Trust of India
BHUBANESWAR

Indian javelin throw superstar Neeraj Chopra will compete in the Asian Games in Japan in September-October in his bid to defend the title, Athletics Federation of India's (AFI) selection committee chairman Adille Sumariwalla confirmed on Saturday.
Recovering from a lower-back injury he had sustained before the Tokyo World Championships in September 2025, Neeraj made a late start to the season at the Doha Diamond League where he finished fourth with a throw of 85.69m.
The 28-year-old two-time Olympic medallist has already confirmed participation in the Commonwealth Games but has not unequivocally said he will compete in the Asian Games in Aichi-Nagoya from September 19 to October 4.
"Yes. He (Neeraj) will participate both in the Commonwealth Games and the Asian Games. He has qualified already and he is recovering."
"He has done 86m (85.69m) in his very first event, which is fantastic,"



Neeraj. FILE PHOTO

Sumariwalla said.
"He won a gold with 88m (in 2022 Asian Games in China), so he is already close to 86m, then we see no reason why he will not do well in both the Commonwealth Games and the Asian Games."
The AFI's selection committee is expected to name the team for the Asian Games on Sunday, the last day of the ongoing National Inter-State Senior Athletics Championships here.
Neeraj had won gold in the last Asian Games in Hangzhou, China, in 2023, with a throw of 88.88m.
In Aichi-Nagoya, Neeraj is expected to face rising Sri Lankan star Rumesh Tharanga Pathirage, who breached the 90m mark earlier this year and won two Diamond League titles, including in Doha where Neeraj finished fourth.

With packed grids and clear-eyed kids, India's karting scene revs up



Plenty of interest: Seventy-five drivers competed across four categories in the opening round.

S. Dipak Ragav
COIMBATORE

India's motorsport culture is still in its nascent stage, despite having hosted World championship events such as F1, MotoGP and Formula E. The country has had only two drivers in F1, the last of whom raced back in 2012. The key to keeping that supply line going is a proper grass-roots-level programme, starting with karting. It is where things have been slow to grow, but the sport has steadily progressed over the last few years.
The sight of tiny tots, all of eight or nine years old, decked in racing suits and helmets, with their parents cheering them on at the opening round of the 2026 edition of the Meco FMSCI National Karting Championship here at the CoASTT circuit, is proof of that rising interest. There

was a grid of 75 drivers across four categories: Micro Max (8-12), Mini Max (10-14), Junior (12-15) and Senior (above 14) on Saturday, with a few more drivers set to join from subsequence rounds. The increasing number of entries, with nine teams fielding drivers across classes, has also transformed the way the series is run.
Former National champion Armaan Ebrahim, who runs the M-Sport team, says: "The current championship has the biggest karting grid in Asia. Equipment-wise, we're on par with the rest of Asia. The chassis used here is the same as in the World championships. There may be slightly different specifications, but fundamentally it's the same equipment."
The increasing professionalism has also translated into rising on-track stan-

dards. "I'm extremely impressed by the level of understanding shown by the youngsters. They are remarkably disciplined and focused. Even eight-year-olds display incredible concentration during races. They understand exactly what they're doing, and that reflects the quality of coaching they receive," says former racing driver Mira Erda, who is Chief of Race Control here.
More importantly, as drivers look to pursue the sport seriously, the teams have had to adapt as well. "Every team is highly professional and employs international engine tuners, coaches and mechanics. It shows how seriously they take performance development, and all of this is excellent for the sport's growth," Armaan adds.
(The writer was in Coimbatore at the invitation of MECO Motosports)

GCL Season 4 draft tomorrow

Sports Bureau

The draft for the fourth edition of the Global Chess League (GCL) will be held in Mumbai on Monday.
The league will see the return of Magnus Carlsen while Divya Deshmukh is set to make her debut. The GCL, a joint venture between Tech Mahindra and FIDE, will be held in Bengaluru from September 3 to 13.
The player pool features 36 GMs, including World champions and leading names from the global circuit. The list includes Viswanathan Anand, Javokhir Sindarov, and K. Humpy among others.

LIVE TELECAST

FIFA World Cup: Unite8 Sports 1, 2 & Z5 App, 7.30 a.m. & 12.30 a.m. (Monday)
Women's T20 World Cup: Star Sports 1 & JioHotstar. 3 p.m.;
Australia vs India, 7 p.m.
England vs New Zealand: Third Test, Day 4, Sony Sports Ten 2 & LIV, 3.30 p.m.
Ireland vs India: Second T20I, Sony Sports Ten 1 & LIV, 6 p.m.
Formula One: Austrian GP, F1 TV, F1 TV Pro App & FanCode, 6.30 p.m.
WI vs SL: First Test, Day 4, FanCode, 7.30 p.m.

Iron Mirage claims feature event

RACING

BENGALURU: Prasanna Kumar trained Iron Mirage (Akshay K up) won the S.M. Cama Music and Production Pvt Ltd Juvenile Sprinters' Million (1,200m), the feature event of the races held here on Saturday (June 27). The winner is owned by Mr. Meka Yugandhar, Capt Jamshed J. Appoo, Mr. K. Manoj Kumar, Mr. Ashok Ranpise & M/s. DT Racing & Breeding LLP.
1. SMART CHIEFTAN PLATE (1,400M): RAMPAGE (Yash) 1, Ashwa New York (Suraj) 2, Shining Path (Akshay K) 3 and Taaqath (S. Saqlain) 4. 2-1/2, 2-3/4 and 1. Im 25.10s. Rs. 15 (w), 11, 10 and 12 (p). SHP: 20, THP: 28, FP: 24, Q: 15, Trinella: 37/42, Exacta: 162/182. Favourite: Rampage.
Owner: J.M. Livestock Pvt Ltd rep. by Mr. Jaydev M. Mody. Trainer: Shazaan Shah.
2. POONAWALLA STUD PLATE (DIV. II), 1,200M: DEFENCE COUNSEL (G. Vivek) 1, Bestidentification (A. Asbar) 2, La McQueen (Aleemuddin) 2 and Aherne (Antony) 4. 4, Hd and 1-1/2. Im 12.49s. Rs. 40 (w), 13, 12 and 13 (p). SHP: 30, THP: 34, FP: 103, Q: 30, Trinella: 206/136, Exacta: 1,332/666. Favourite: Bestidentification.

Owner: Mr. M. Venkatesh. Trainer: S. Dominic.
3. ASTRONOMIC PLATE (2,000M): YOUREMANORBORNE (Sandesh) 1, Winfield (Antony) 2, Storm Shadow (G. Vivek) 3 and Badshaah (Abdul Fazal) 4. Not run: Maana. 3/4, 1 and 2. 2m 08.67s. Rs. 14 (w), 10, 11 and 11 (p). SHP: 23, THP: 32, FP: 23, Q: 24, Trinella: 40/26, Exacta: 168/109. Favourite: Youremanorborne. Owner: Mr. B. Vijeth Bhandari. Trainer: P.S. Chouhan.
4. MANAGING COMMITTEE GOLD CUP (1,600M): PROMISEOFTHEFUTURE (Neeraj) 1, Xanthe (Hindu S) 2, Touch Of Grey (Saurav Rawat) 3 and Victor Hugo (A. Hangal) 4. Not run: Emphatic. 4-1/4, 3 and 2-1/2. Im 36.94s. Rs. 19 (w), 11 and 13 (p). SHP: 21, THP: 38, FP: 31, Q: 22, Trinella: 214/159, Exacta: 699/202. Favourite: Promiseofthefuture. Owner: Ms. Ameeta Mehra. Trainer: Irfan Ghatala.
5. S.M. CAMA MUSIC AND PRODUCTION PVT LTD JUVENILE SPIN-TERS' MILLION (1,200M): IRON MIRAGE (Dreamfield- Setareh) Akshay K 1, Shrishti (Win Legend-Bright Future) Yash 2, A Great Buzz (Leitir Mor - Flaming Mir-tini) Pavan 3 and Burevestnik (Air-Support - Defiance) Sandesh 4. 9-1/2, 3/4 and 9-1/4. Im 11.39s. Rs. 11 (w), 10 and 31 (p), SHP: 46, THP:

23, FP: 61, Q: 40, Trinella: 204/37, Exacta: 128/56. Favourite: Iron Mirage.
Owners: Mr. Meka Yugandhar, Capt Jamshed J. Appoo, Mr. K. Manoj Kumar, Mr. Ashok Ranpise & M/s. DT Racing & Breeding LLP. Trainer: Prasanna Kumar.
6. MALAKPET PLATE (1,300M): SHINING WAYS (Suraj) 1, Power Of The Sea (S. Shareef) 2, Lasya (Vishal Bunde) 3 and Rocking Star (R. Pradeep) 4. Not run: Big B. 3, 1 and 3/4. Im 19.26s. Rs. 14 (w), 13, 22 and 31 (p), SHP: 69, THP: 53, FP: 196, Q: 102, Trinella: 991/328, Exacta: 3,866/1,656. Favourite: Shining Ways.
Owners: Mr. Daulat Chhabria, Mr. Teja Gollapudi, Dr. Prabhakar Chowdary Tripuraneni & Mr. Ashok Ranpise. Trainer: S. Narredu.
7. POONAWALLA STUD PLATE (DIV. I), 1,200M: KABALI (R. Pradeep) 1, Felisa (Arvind K) 2, Aquatic (S. Sachin) 3 and Senor Cherie (Akshay K) 4. 2-3/4, 1/2 and 1-1/2. Im 11.48s. Rs. 67 (w), 19, 17 and 12 (p). SHP: 49, THP: 40, FP: 1,483, Q: 631, Trinella: 1,376/944, Exacta: 7,508/3,217. Favourite: Aquatic. Owner: Mr. Santhosh. P. Trainer: G. Sandhu.
Jackpot: Rs. 1,908; Runner up: 27; Mini Jackpot: 1,139; Treble (i): 171; (ii): 505.

BENGALURU: Knotty Charmer and Rieko may fight out the finish of the Chief Minister's Cup (1,200m), the chief event of the races to be held here on Sunday (June 28).
False rails (width about 5m from 1,600m to the winning post) will be in position.
1. LITTLELOVER PLATE (1,200m), maiden 3-y-o only, (Terms), 2.00 p.m.: 1. Auspicious King (6) Kiran Rai 56, 2. Calix (7) Akshay K 56, 3. Panache (9) G. Vivek 56, 4. Abbakka (2) Arvind K 54.5, 5. Charming Prospect (8) A. Asbar 54.5, 6. Haniel (1) Arul 54.5, 7. Preview (5) Suraj 54.5, 8. Sai Princess (4) Jagadeesh 54.5 and 9. Time Tester (3) Darshan 54.5.
1. CALIX, 2. HANIEL, 3. PREVIEW
2. MAHALAKSHMI PLATE (1,600m), rated 00 to 25, 2.30: 1. Detective Conan (9) Arul 61.5, 2. Sea Diamond (8) Vishal S 61.5, 3. Big Sauce (7) Pavan 61, 4. Magna Carta (3) S. Sachin 61, 5. Superhero (2) Bhawani S 60.5, 6. Michiko (4) Kiran Rai 59.5, 7. Bruce Almighty (6) Neeraj 59, 8. Rising Form (5) Faizan Khan 58 and 9. Princess Jasmine (1) Suhas K 56.
1. MICHIKO, 2. MAGNA CARTA, 3. SEA DIAMOND
3. RICHELIEU STAKES (1,400m), rated 20 to 45, 3.00: 1. Queen-dom (7) Akshay K 60, 2. Dream Walkin' (2) G. Vivek 59, 3. Super Charm (1) Saurav Rawat 59, 4. Mericle Beauty (6) Ankush 58.5, 5. Steely Challenge (4) Antony 58, 6. Lightning Blitz (8) Suraj 57, 7. Lots Of Luck (x) (i) 56.5 and 8. Tiger Bay (3) Kiran Rai 56.5.
1. STEELY CHALLENGE, 2. LIGHTNING BLITZ, 3. DREAM WALKIN'
4. CHIEF MINISTER'S CUP (1,200m), 4-y-o over, (Terms), 3.30: 1. Knotty Charmer (3) Antony 60, 2. Crown Drive (5) Hindu S 57, 3. Dream Seller (4) Sandesh 57, 4. Kalamitsi (2) Akshay K 57 and 5. Rieko (1) Neeraj 57.
1. KNOTTY CHARMER, 2. RIEKO
5. KARNATAKA SUB-AREA CUP (1,400m), rated 60 to 85, 4.00: 1. Sekhmet (5) Rayan 60, 2. Mahler (7) G. Vivek 57.5, 3. Vegatha (2) Antony 57, 4. Irish Coffee (1) Arul 56, 5. Gachchhatu (8) Neeraj 56, 6. Jersey King (6) Lave Kumar 53, 7. Lux Aeterna (4) Akshay K 53 and 8. Victoria

Doreasani (3) L.A. Rozario 51.
1. MAHLER, 2. VEGATHA, 3. GACHCHHATU
6. TUDOR JET PLATE (1,200m), rated 20 to 45, 5-y-o & over, 4.30: 1. El Alamein (5) Vishwa V 60.5, 2. Agera (8) L.A. Rozario 59, 3. Noble Cause (6) S. Sachin 58.5, 4. IL Volo (1) Kiran Rai 58, 5. Carat Love (3) Akshay K 57, 6. River Deep (2) A. Asbar 56.5, 7. Super Kind (4) Vishal S 56, 8. Chotipari (9) Abhishek Mhatre 55 and 9. Glorious Spectre (7) Arul 55.
1. RIVER DEEP, 2. CARAT LOVE, 3. IL VOLO
7. DESERT GOD PLATE (1,600m), rated 20 to 45, 5.00: 1. Pledge (4) Akshay K 62.5, 2. Luca (6) S. Sachin 60, 3. Imperador (8) Vishal Bunde 57.5, 4. Shahenshaah (3) Abdul Fazal 57.5, 5. Regal Aristocracy (1) Antony 57, 6. Razzmatazz (5) Aditya W 56, 7. Absolute Thunder (7) Sai Kiran 52.5 and 8. Art Of Romance (2) Kiran Rai 52.
1. PLEDGE, 2. IMPERADOR, 3. REGAL ARISTOCRACY
Day's best: STEELY CHALLENGE
Double: CALIX-MAHLER
Jkt: 3, 4, 5, 6 and 7; Mini Jkt: 4, 5, 6 and 7; Tr: (i): 2, 3 and 4; (ii): 5, 6 and 7.



Class apart: India u-19 women proved too good for Sri Lanka.

Coach Nooshin aims to build bench strength

U-19 CRICKET

Rajdeep Saha
CHENNAI

The India under-19 women's team sealed a 3-0 whitewash over Sri Lanka u-19 with a lap of honour around the M.A. Chidambaram Stadium as a mark of gratitude to the 500-odd spectators who egged them on. Watching on from a distance was head coach Nooshin Al Khadeer, who has made successes something of a habit.
Nooshin, who took over the u-19 set-up in 2022, will eye a hat-trick of T20 World Cup crowns when the third edition starts early next year. "We have zonal camps in April and May. Usually, they're at different venues, but we were

lucky to have this year's camp at the Bengaluru Centre of Excellence," Nooshin told *The Hindu*.
Nooshin and the selectors will keep close tabs on the domestic season, which starts with the u-19 T20 Trophy Elite on Oct. 9, and assignments like the tour of England and the proposed Asia Cup to firm up the World Cup squad.
"The ultimate goal is to reach a point where we can push in two Indian teams coming in, and that's going to happen... I'm not too crazy about the limelight. These players are the ones who are going to steal the show".
The scores: Sri Lanka u-19 116/7 in 20 overs (Nethmi Upeksha 51 n.o.) lost to India u-19 120/3 in 18.4 overs (Bhavika Ahire 50);
Toss: Sri Lanka.
PoS: Upeksha; **Pos:** Bhavika.



Generational craft: A craftsman heating a *khukuri* knife in a furnace before shaping it by hand in Patan, Nepal. The skills have been passed down through generations.



Precise detailing: A blacksmith shapes a red-hot *khukuri* blade with a hammer during the traditional forging process at a workshop.



Final touches: The knife is sharpened on a machine during the finishing process in a traditional workshop.



Mark of pride: Nepali Army personnel place their *khukuris* against their chests as a mark of respect before beginning a drill. The *khukuri* continues to play an important part in military training.

Khukur: a symbol of courage and loyalty

Once used by the Gorkha soldiers to fight the British Army, the *khukuri* knife's uses have transformed over time according to the needs of the Nepali people, who continue to use it extensively in combat as well as in their homes



Prabhat Khanal

The *khukuri* knife is an iconic symbol of the Gorkha military, originally from Nepal, and is closely associated with the Gorkha soldier, symbolising strength, courage, bravery and loyalty. A typical *khukuri* blade has a distinctive curved shape, and a hard blade, measuring 16 to 18 inches, can be used as both a weapon during combat and a tool in Nepal. *Khukuris* are forged from spring steel with a notch at the end of the blade, designed so that blood and sap drip off the knife instead of seeping onto the hardwood handle. According to the Nepal Army, after 1744, the *khukuri* worn by the Gorkha soldiers who fought under the leadership of Prithvi Narayan Shah, who was the king of the Gorkha kingdom, in the Nepal Unification Campaign, made a significant contribution to the creation of modern Nepal. When Britain initially encountered Gorkhas in the mountains of Nepal in 1814, the Gorkhas fought so fiercely and admirably with their *khukuris*. After that, the *khukuri* became the symbol of courage, bravery, and warfare skills of

the Gorkha soldier, and they were recruited into the British Army. Now, the Indian Army currently fields seven active Gorkha Rifles regiments and the British Army has one primary Gorkha infantry regiment, The Royal Gorkha Rifles (RGR). The Nepal Army uses the *khukuri* as a combat weapon, a survival tool in field operations, and an important part of military training. It is also carried during parades and ceremonial events, cultural events, symbolising the courage, tradition, and identity of Nepali soldiers. Though the *khukuri* is best known as a ruthless combat weapon, the knife has several other uses. Gorkhas can use their *khukuris* to chop or carve wood, cut meat and vegetables, dig, and hunt wild animals. The act of sharpening a *khukuri* is a ritualistic process, symbolising the soldier's commitment to duty and honour. People of Nepal worship the *khukuri* during various festivals. Although the *khukuri* has undergone some changes in its appearance from ancient times to the modern era, its importance, respect, and identity have not diminished.



Firm grip: A man demonstrating the proper handling of a handcrafted *khukuri* knife in a factory, showcasing its precision, balance, and readiness for action.

